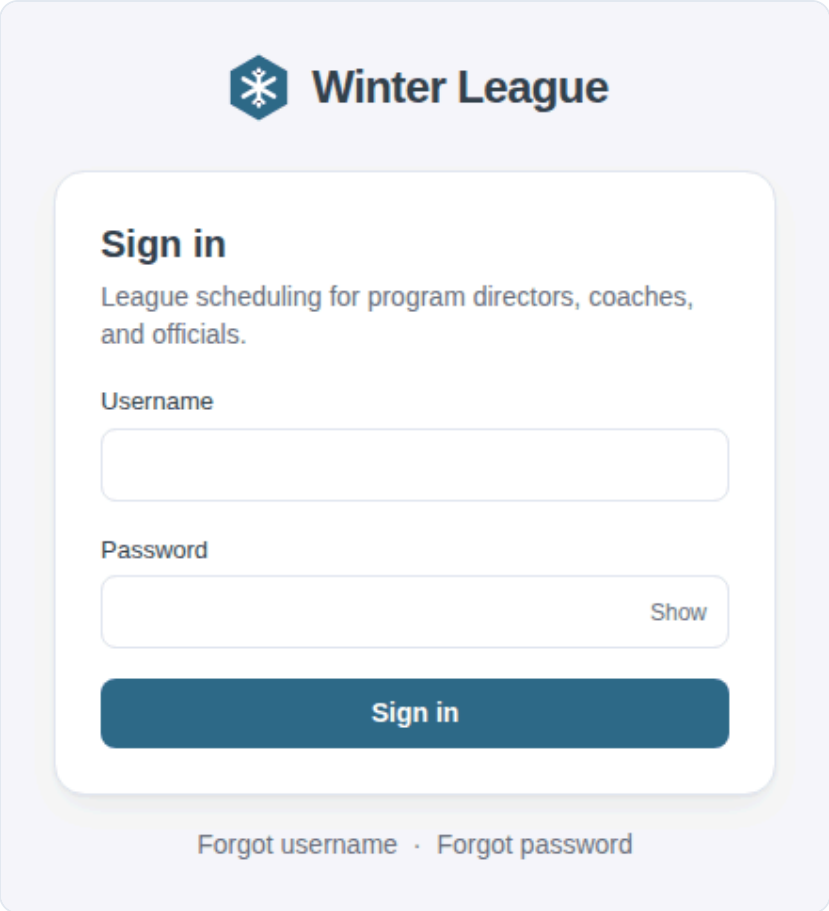
System Admin guide

System Admins run the league: they set up seasons, programs, and accounts, build and publish the schedule, give the final sign-off on schedule changes, and can see and do everything in Winter League.

Getting started

Signing in

1. Open the league's web address in any browser, on a computer or a phone.
2. Enter the **username** and **password** your league sent you, then **Sign in**.
3. The first time, you'll be asked to choose your own password. It needs at least 10 characters, including a letter and a number.

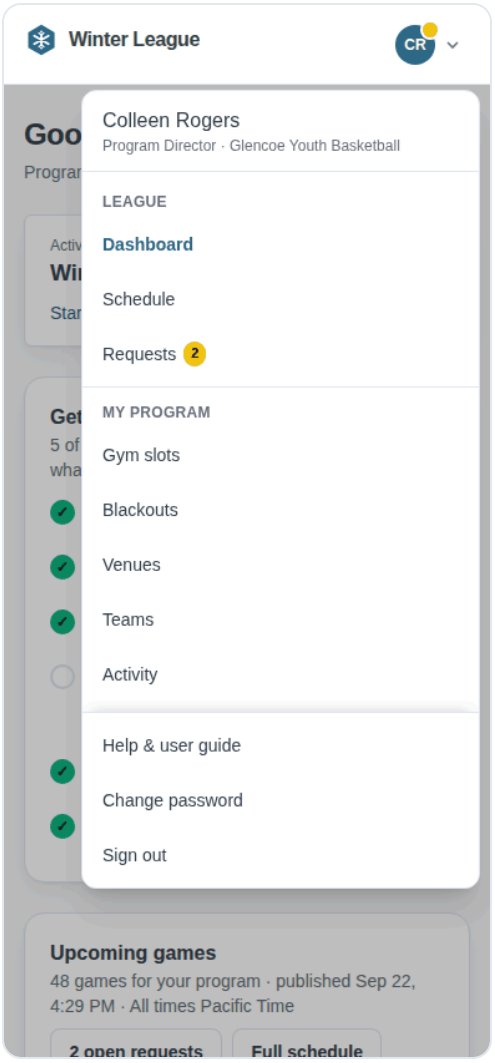


The sign-in page

Forgot something? Under the sign-in box, **Forgot username** emails you your username, and **Forgot password** emails you a link to set a new one. The link works once and expires after an hour.

Finding your way around

- **On a computer,** the main pages run across the top. Everything else is under your name in the top-right corner.
- **On a phone,** tap your initials in the top-right corner. The menu is organised into sections, and **Help**, **Change password**, and **Sign out** are always at the bottom. Tap anywhere outside the menu to close it.



The menu on a phone

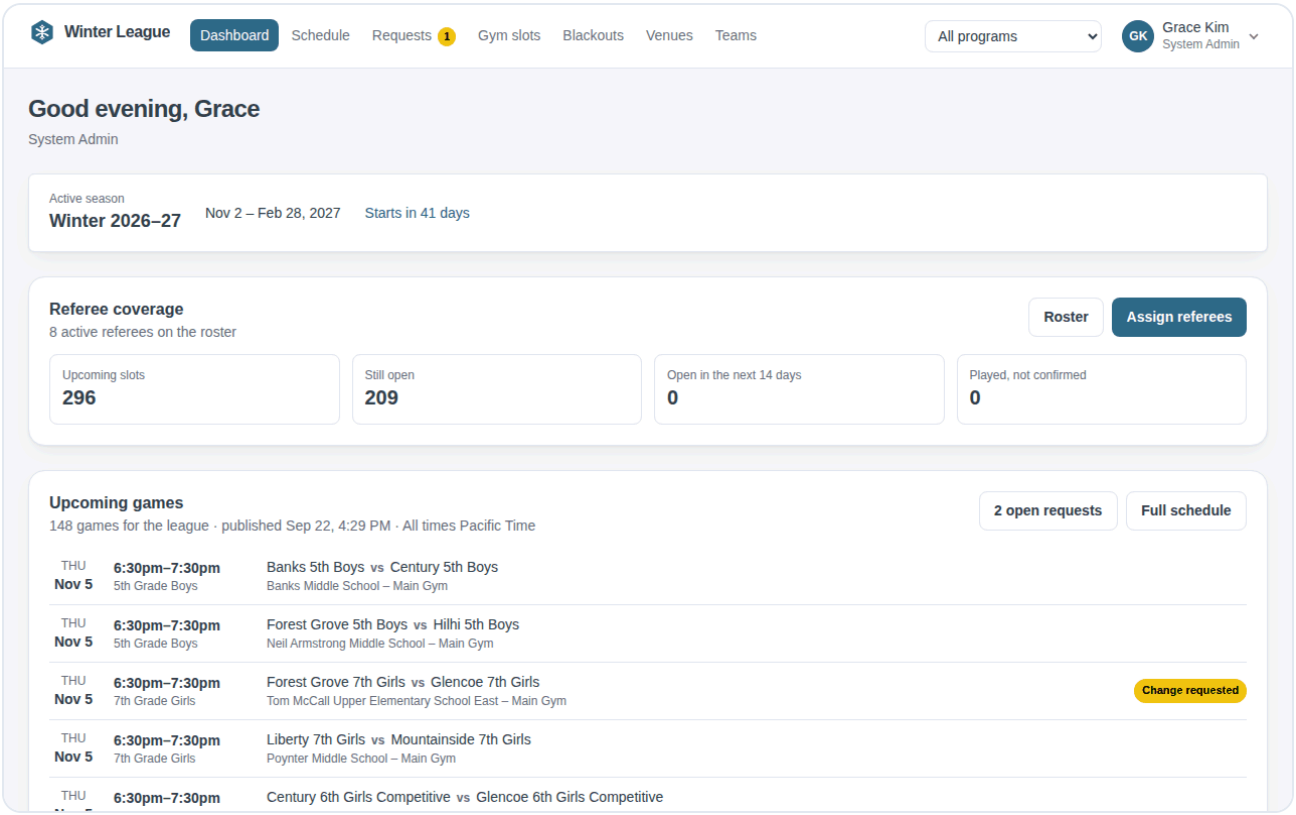
A small dot on your initials, or a number next to **Requests**, means something is waiting for you.

Good to know

- **All times are Pacific Time,** whatever time zone your phone or computer is set to.
- **Closing the browser tab signs you out.** You can also choose **Sign out** from the menu. On a shared computer, always sign out.
- **This guide** is always under **Help** in the menu, and you can download it as a PDF from the top of this page.

Your dashboard

The dashboard shows the active season, referee coverage, upcoming games, and each program's setup progress, so you can see at a glance which programs still need to enter gym time, venues, or teams.



The System Admin dashboard

The **All programs** dropdown in the header narrows pages like Gym slots, Venues, and Teams to one program. Set it back to **All programs** to see the whole league.

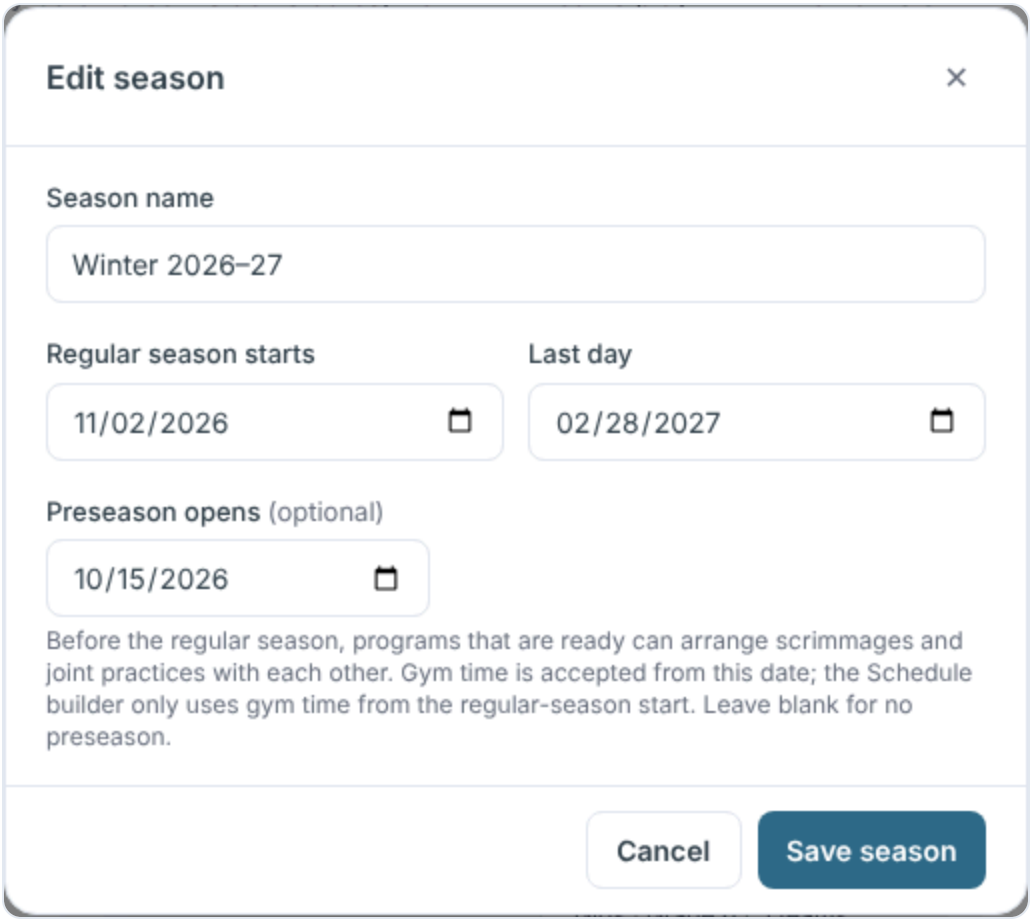
Setting up a new season

Do these in order before programs start entering gym time.

1. The season and divisions

Menu → League admin → League setup.

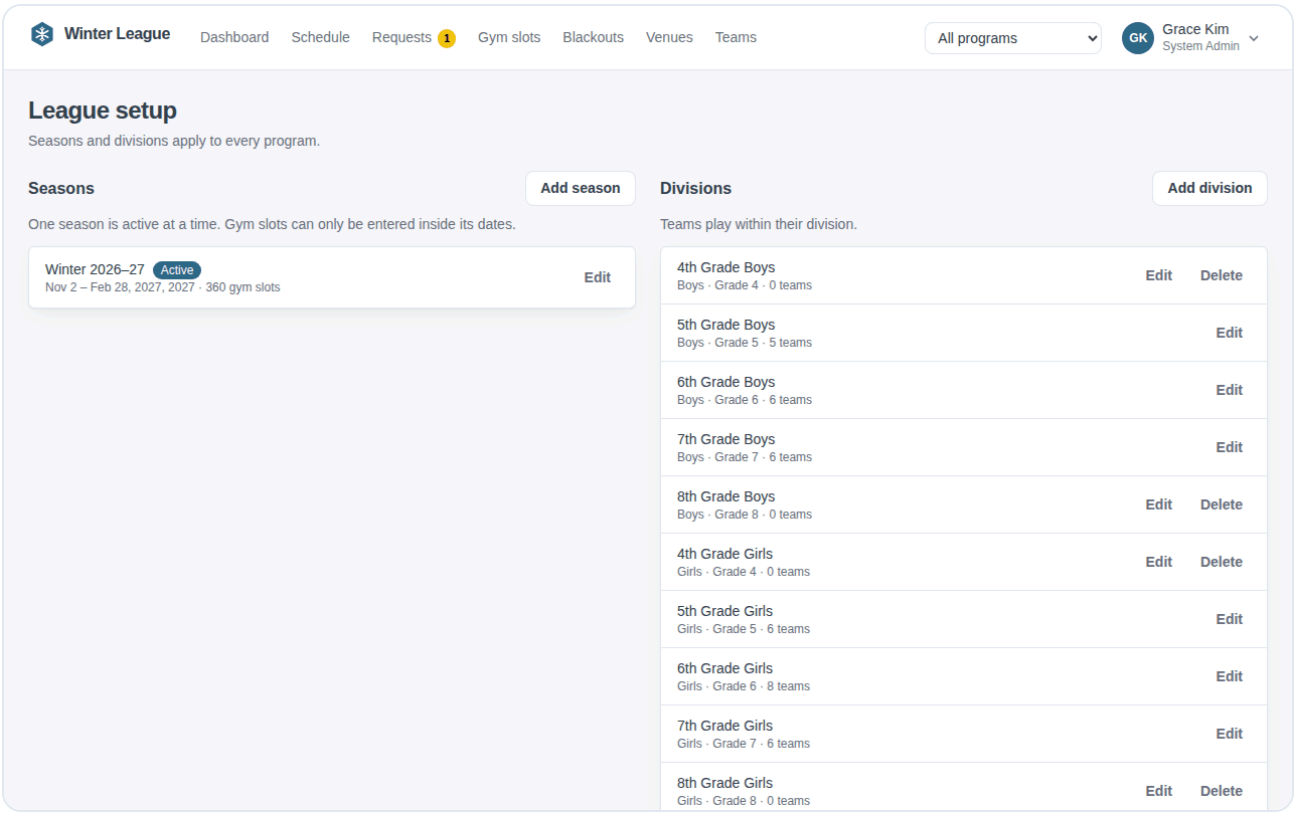
- **Season: Add season** with its first and last day, and use **Make active** if it isn't already the active season. Only one season is active at a time; gym slots, blackouts, and the schedule all belong to it.
- **Preseason (optional):** set **Preseason opens** on the season (e.g. November 2, with the regular season starting January 4). Programs can then add gym time from that date, open their teams for preseason, and arrange scrimmages and joint practices with each other. The Schedule builder only uses gym time from the regular-season start, so preseason time is never taken by league games. Leave it blank for no preseason.



Season with a preseason

- **Divisions:** the grade and gender groups teams play in (e.g. *6th Grade Girls*). A new league starts with none (or with ten starter divisions, if they were added when the database was set

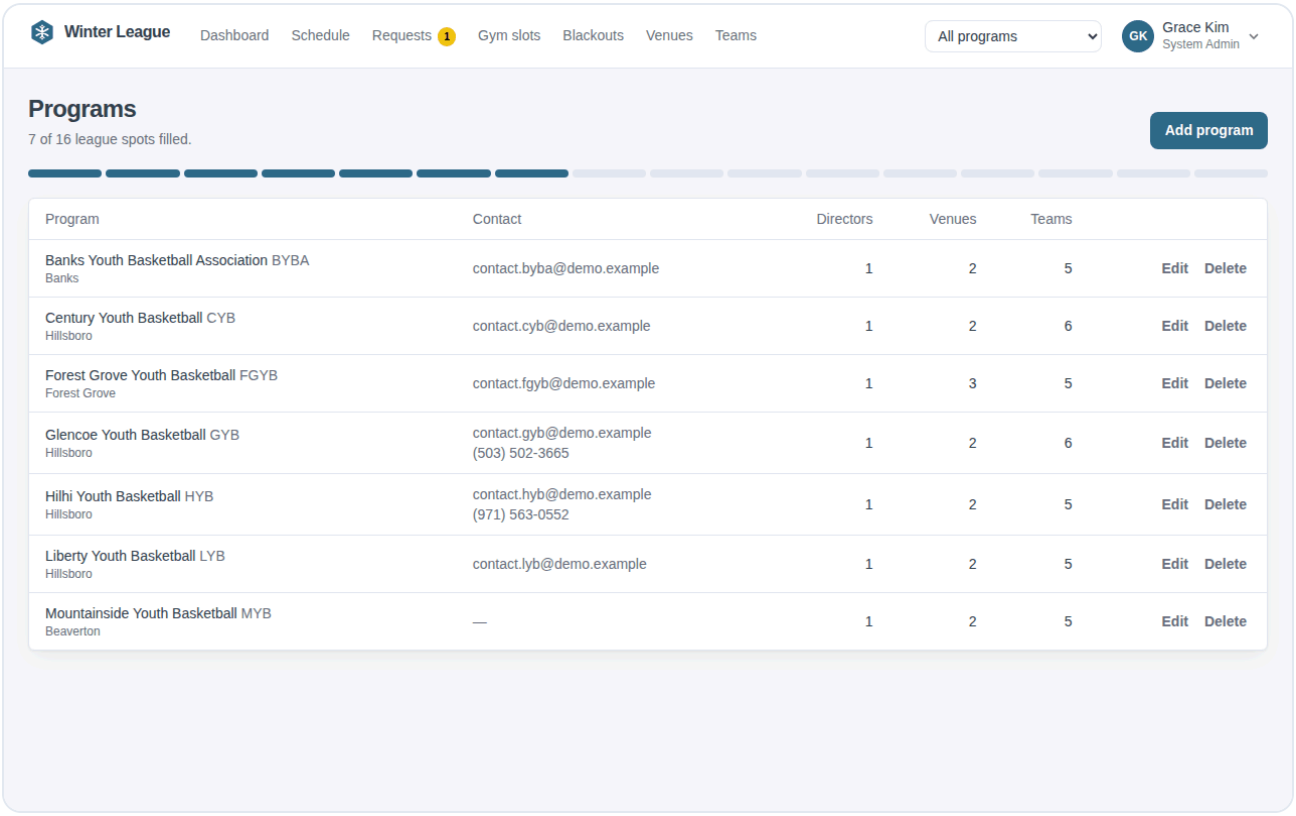
up); add, rename, or deactivate them to match your league. Teams only ever play teams in their own division.



League setup

2. Programs

Menu → League admin → Programs → Add program. Each club or organisation is a program, with a name, a 2–6 letter short code (e.g. *GYB*), and contact details. The bar at the top shows how many of the league's program spots are used.



Programs

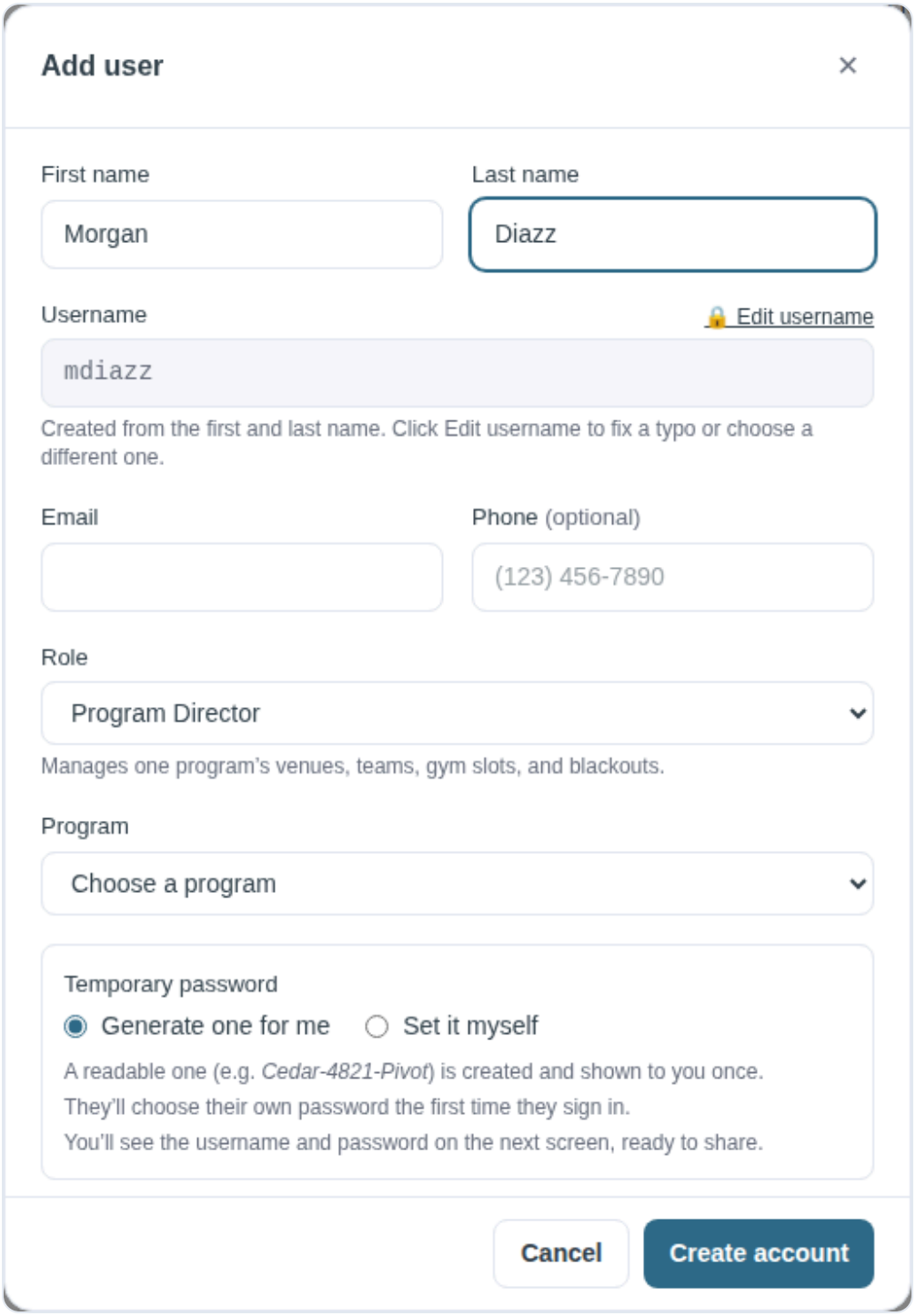
Deactivating a program: edit it and untick **Active in the league**. It stays on this page (greyed out, marked *inactive*) with all its history, but it disappears from the drop-down lists: the program menu in the top bar, and the Program list when you add a user, team, venue, or gym slot. Its teams are left out of new drafts. Tick **Active in the league** again and it comes straight back. People already in an inactive program keep it when you edit their account (shown as *inactive*), but nobody new can be added to it.

Outside clubs the league plays now and then are **guest programs**, set up further down the same page. See Guest (non-conference) teams.

3. Accounts

Menu → League admin → Users → Add user. Choose the person's role and, for Program Directors and Coaches, their program.

Username. As you type the first and last name, the **Username** box fills in with the username the app will create (first initial and last name, e.g. *mdiaz*, with a number added if it's taken). It's locked so it can't be changed by accident. To use a different one (say, to fix a typo in the name), click 🔒 **Edit username**, then type it. It's checked as you type: 3–30 characters (lowercase letters, numbers, and `.` `_` `-`), and not already taken. **Create account** stays greyed out until it's fine. **Use the suggested username** locks it again and goes back to the generated one.

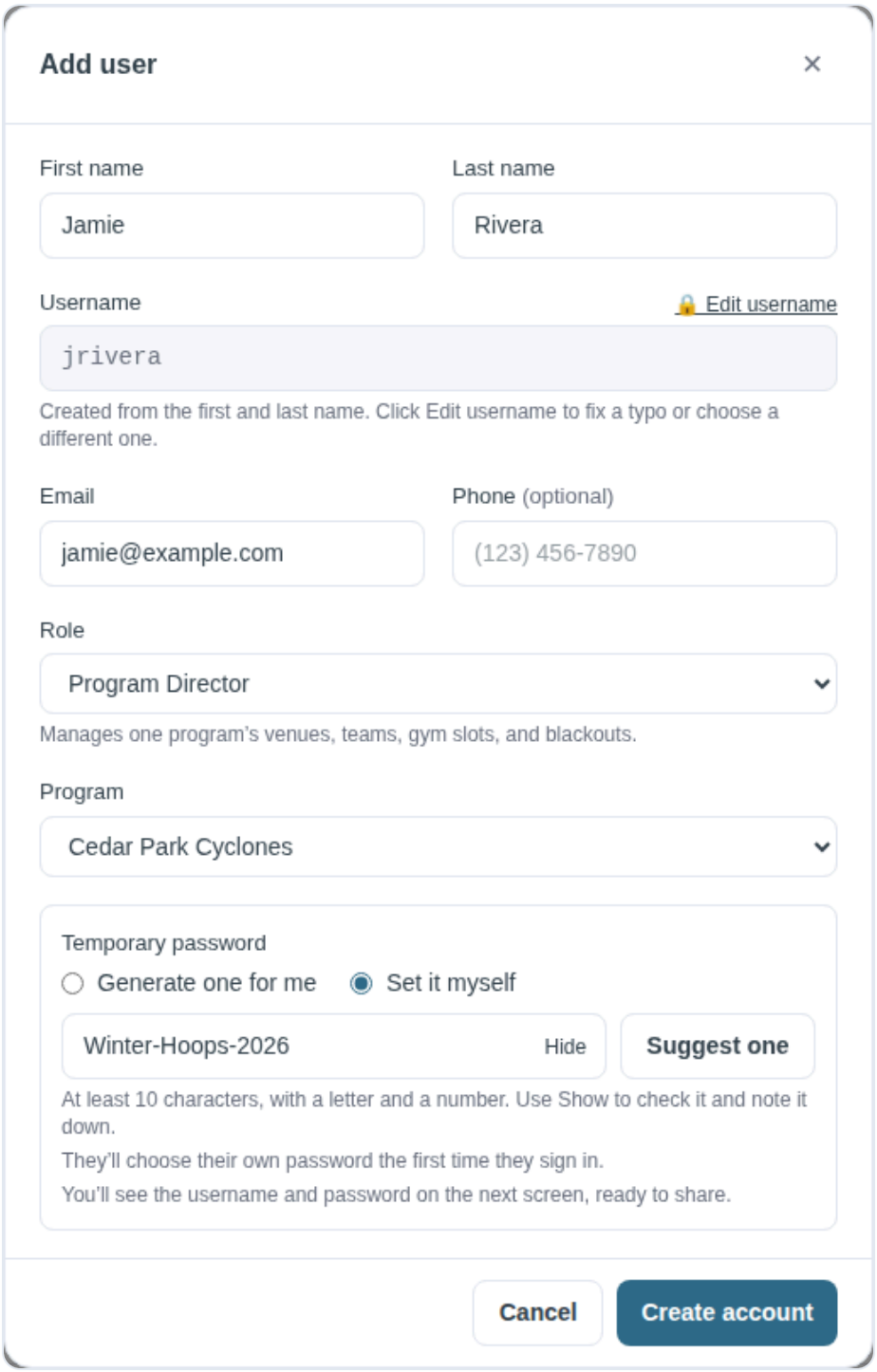


The username, filled in from the name

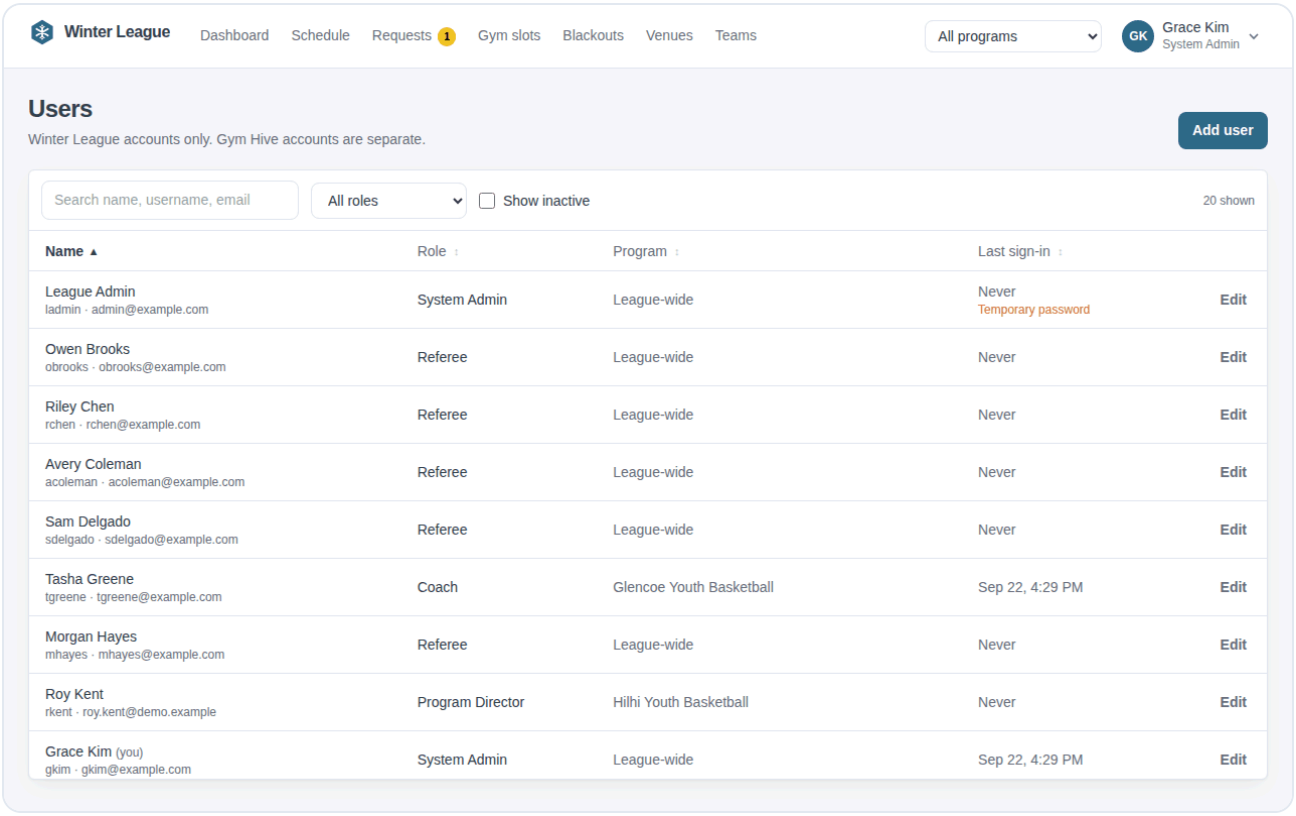
Under **Temporary password**, choose:

- **Generate one for me** (the default): the app makes a readable one, e.g. *Cedar-4821-Pivot*.
- **Set it myself**: type the password you want to give them, or click **Suggest one** and adjust it. It must be at least 10 characters with a letter and a number, and the box tells you what's missing. Click **Show** to check what you typed and note it down (**Hide** masks it again).

The next screen shows the username and temporary password **once**. The password is masked; click **Show** to see it, or **Copy sign-in details** to send both. They choose their own password the first time they sign in.

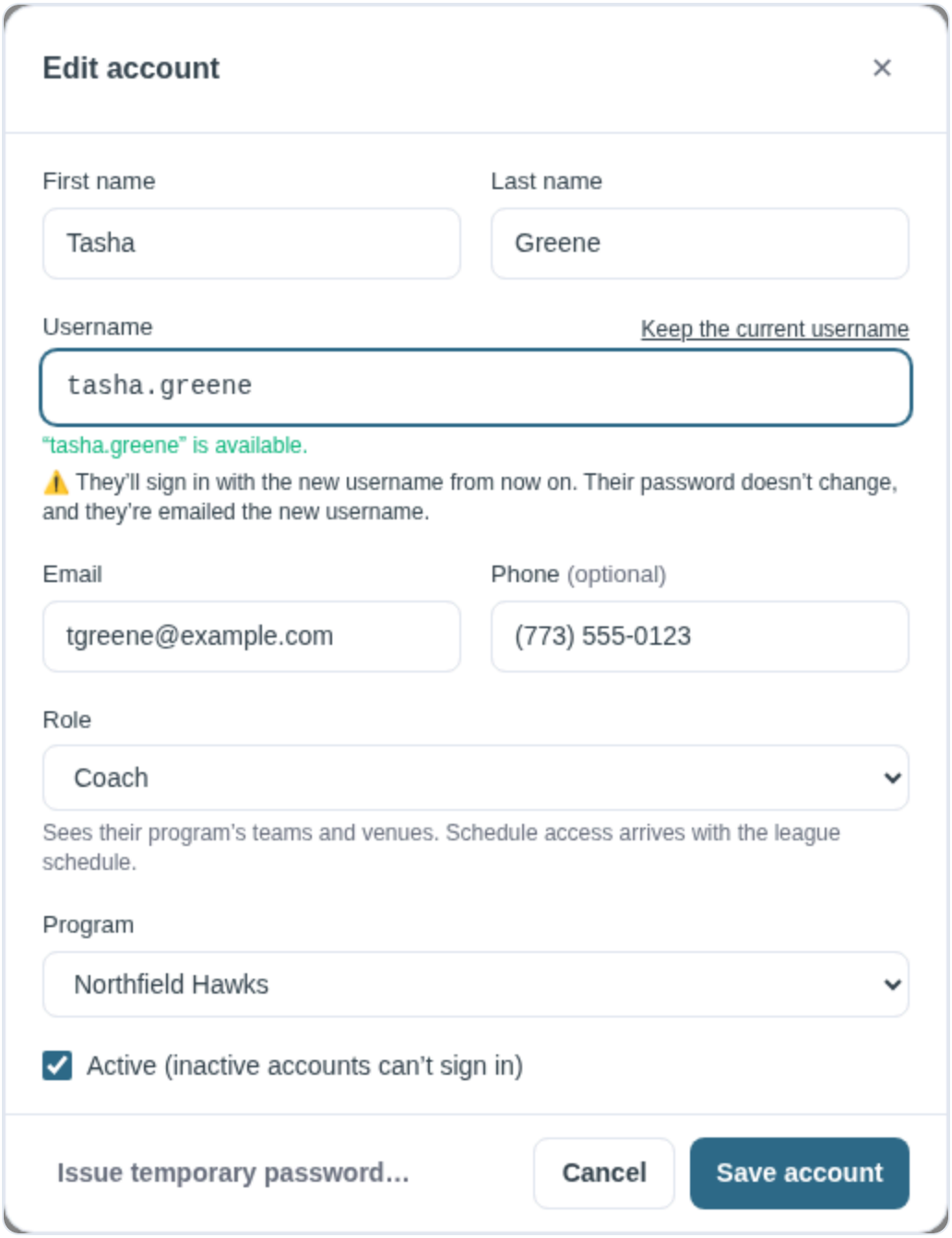


Adding a user with a temporary password you set



Users

- **Sorting and searching:** click **Name**, **Role**, **Program**, or **Last sign-in** to sort; search by name, username, or email; filter by role.
- **Someone locked out?** Open their account and choose **Issue temporary password…**. Pick **Generate one for me** or **Set it myself** (with **Show** and **Suggest one**, as above), then **Issue password**. Their old password stops working straight away, and the new one is shown once for you to share. Activity records that a temporary password was issued, and whether you set it, but never the password itself.
- **Fixing a username:** open the account and click 🔒 **Change username**, then type the corrected one (checked as you type, as above) and **Save account**. They sign in with the new username from then on. Their password doesn't change, they're emailed the new username, and Activity records the change. **Keep the current username** cancels it.



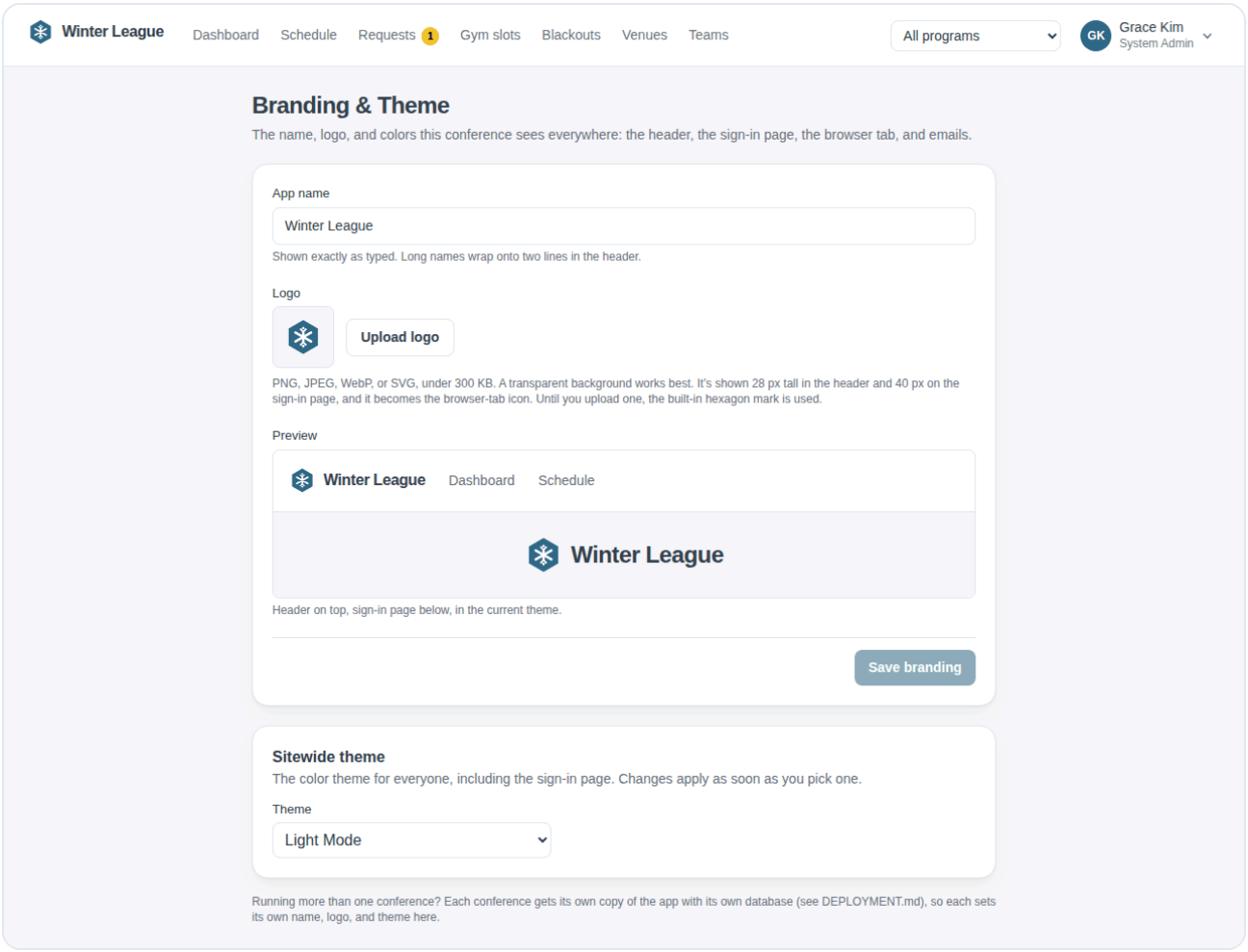
Changing a username

- **Someone leaving?** Untick **Active** in their account. They can no longer sign in, but their history stays.
- Referees can also be added by the Referee Assignor on the **Referees** page.
- **Program directories:** Program Directors keep a contact list under **Directory** (coaches without an account yet, referees, team managers, and so on). Those contacts aren't accounts and can't sign in. You can see every program's directory under **Programs & gyms → Directory** (pick a program in the header to see just one). A Directory coach can be a team's head coach until you create their Coach account; the director then switches the team over in one click.

Role	What they do
System Admin	Everything in this guide
Program Director	Runs one program: venues, teams, gym slots, blackouts, and approving its schedule changes
Coach	Sees their teams' schedule and asks for changes
Referee Assignor	Manages referees: roster, assignments, attendance, and payouts
Referee	Sees their games, checks in, and marks dates they can't work

4. Branding & Theme

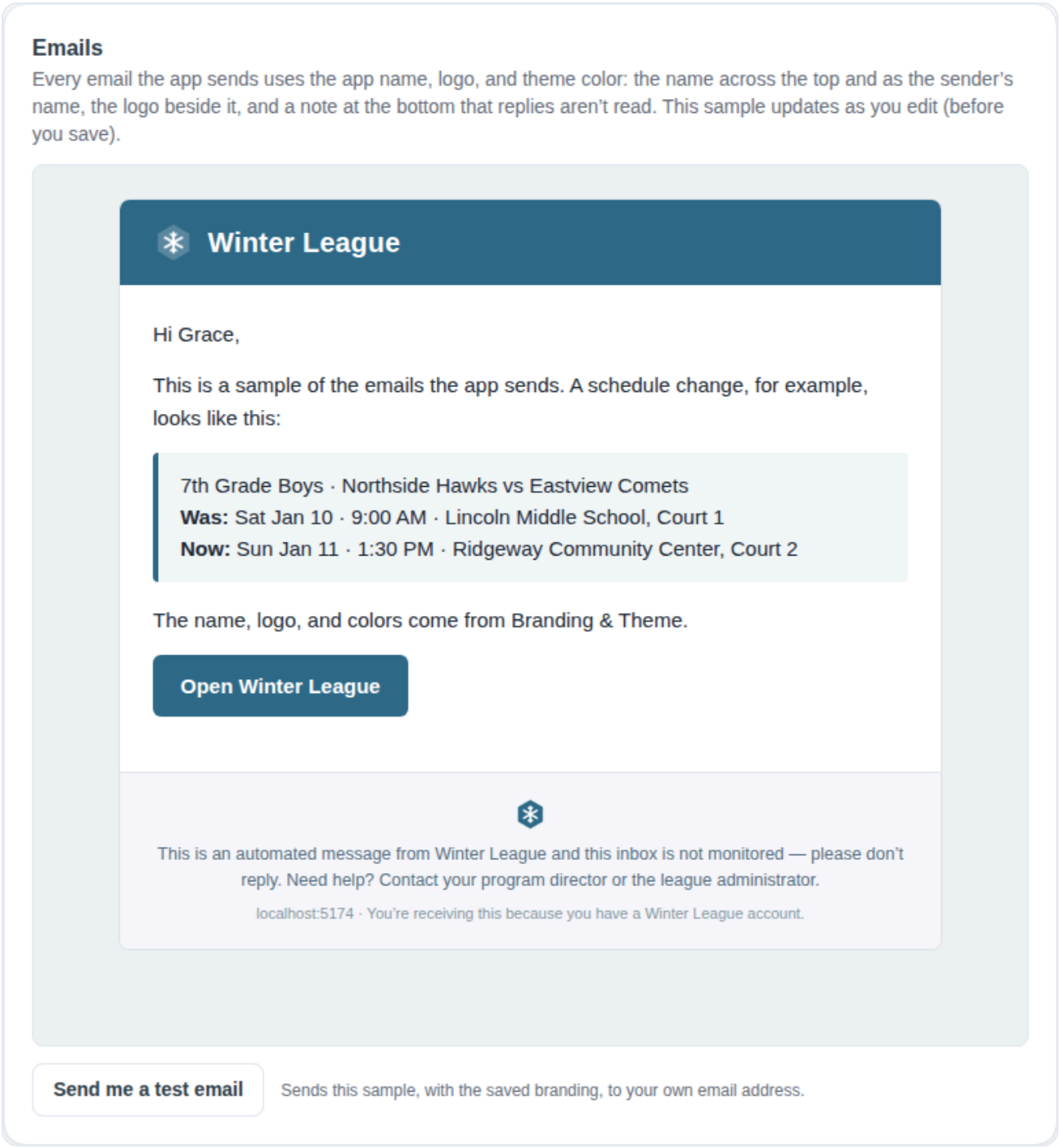
Menu → League admin → Branding & Theme. Set the name shown across the app and in emails, upload a logo (PNG, JPEG, WebP, or SVG under 300 KB), and pick the sitewide color theme: **Light**, **Dark**, **Regal Opulence**, **Midnight Noir**, **Pacific Energy**, **Midnight Pacific**, or **Concrete Sage** (calm and architectural: graphite top bar, sage panels, an oat background, and a warm clay for buttons). The theme is chosen only here (it's no longer in the top bar), and applies to everyone as soon as you pick it. The preview shows your name and logo changes before you save.



Branding & Theme

Emails use the same branding. Every email the app sends has the app name across the top (it's also the sender's name in the inbox), your logo beside it, buttons in the theme's color, and a footer saying the inbox isn't monitored and who to contact instead: coaches are pointed to their program director, referees to the assignor, and directors and the assignor to you. The **Emails** section at the bottom of the page shows a sample that updates as you edit, before you save.

- **Logo in emails:** email apps don't show SVG logos, so when you save, the server also makes a small PNG copy of your logo for emails. Emails load it from the web, so for it to show reliably the server needs image storage (Vercel Blob) set up once: see EMAIL-SETUP.md, Step 6. If it isn't, **Send me a test email** says so. Until you upload a logo, emails use the built-in hexagon mark in the theme's colors.
- **Send me a test email** sends the sample to your own address, so you can check how it looks in your inbox and that sending works. If the server isn't set up to send yet, it says so (the email is only written to the server log); see EMAIL-SETUP.md for setting up Brevo.



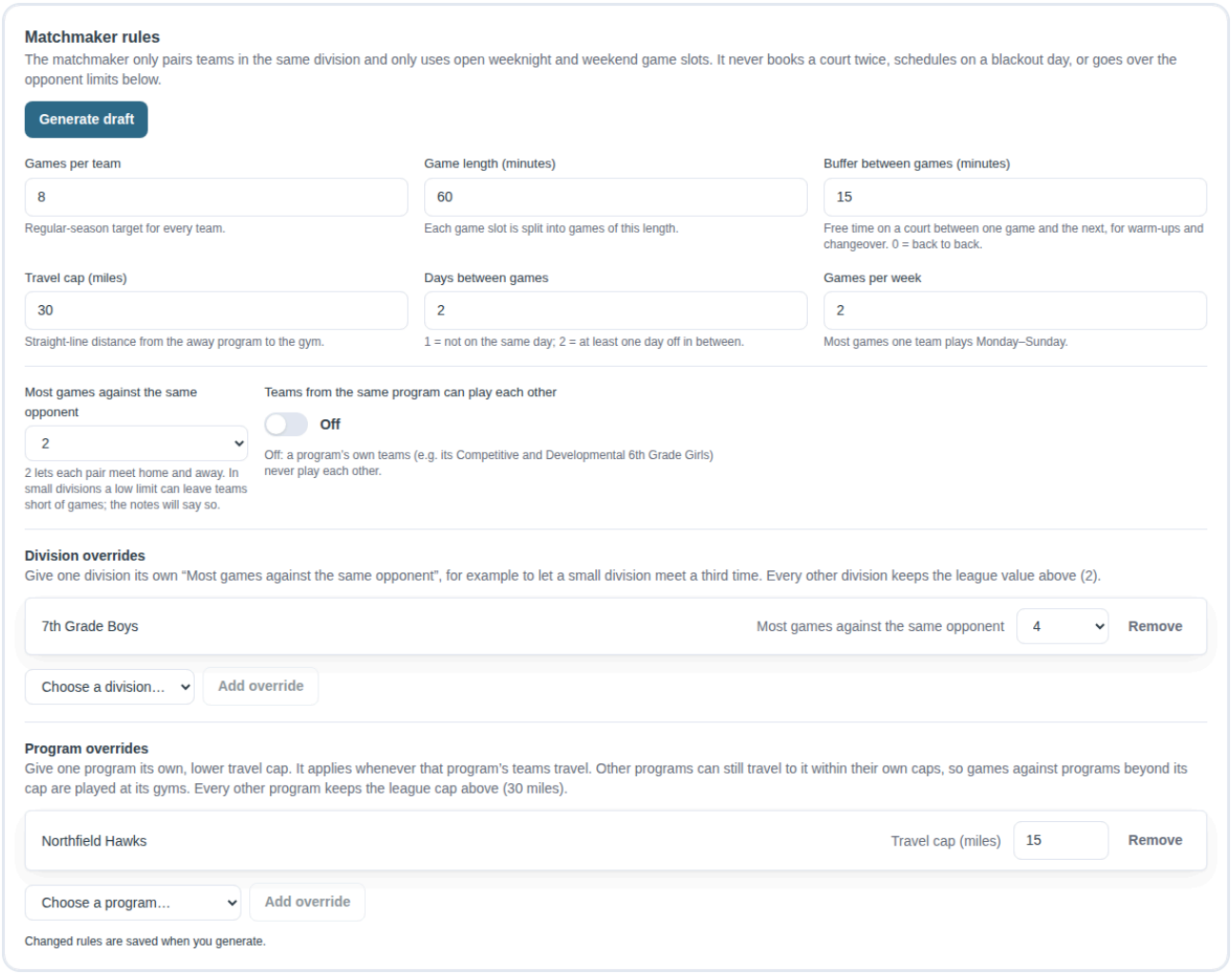
The Emails section with the sample email

Building and publishing the schedule

Once programs have entered their gym slots, blackouts, and teams, the Schedule builder creates the season's games. Nothing is visible to coaches, directors, or referees until you publish.

1. Check the rules

Menu → Scheduling → Schedule builder. If there's no active season yet, the page lists what to set up first (the season, divisions, programs and their directors, then teams, venues and gym slots), with a link to each. **Generate draft** also tells you what's still missing (for example *no teams yet*, or *no game slots for this season*) rather than making an empty draft. If programs have sent rule requests that are waiting for an answer, a line above the rules says how many.



Matchmaker rules

Rule	What it does	Default
Games per team	The target for every team	8
Game length	Each game slot is split into back-to-back games this long	60 minutes
Buffer between games	Free time on a court between one game and the next, for warm-ups and changeover. With 60-minute games and a 15-minute buffer, a 6:30–9:00 slot holds games at 6:30 and 7:45. Fewer games fit in each slot, so check the draft for teams left short. If you place a game by hand closer than the buffer, you're warned but can go ahead.	0 minutes (back to back)
Travel cap	Furthest the away team should travel (a program can have its own, lower cap, see below)	30 miles
Days between games	2 means at least one day off between a team's games	2
Games per week	Most games one team plays Monday–Sunday	2
Most games against the same opponent	How often the same two teams can meet	2
Teams from the same program can play each other	Off means a program's own teams never meet	Off

Division overrides

The rules above apply to every division. When one division needs something different, add a **division override** under the rules instead of changing the league value for everyone. For now, the setting a division can override is **Most games against the same opponent**.

1. Under **Division overrides**, choose the division and click **Add override**.

2. Pick that division's value (1–6, or **No limit**). It starts one step above the league value, since the usual reason is a small division that needs more rematches to reach its games-per-team target.
3. Click **Generate draft** (or **Regenerate draft**). Overrides, like the other rules, are saved when you generate.

Every other division keeps the league value. To go back to the league value, click **Remove** next to the division. "Same as the league value" next to a row means the override currently changes nothing.

When to use one: the matchmaker's notes say a team "got 4 of 8 games: it has 2 possible opponents in 7th Grade Boys and a limit of 2 games against each". Rather than raising the limit for the whole league, give just that division an override of 4.

A director can ask for one with a rule request; accepting it adds the override here.

After you generate, a line above the notes shows the overrides the draft was built with (for example, *Built with division override: 7th Grade Boys — at most 4 games against the same opponent*). Each draft keeps its own copy of the rules, so changing an override later doesn't change a draft or published schedule already built. If an override is what leaves teams short, the note says so and tells you to raise the division override. The Activity log records override changes with the rules.

Program overrides (travel cap)

A program can have its own **travel cap**, lower than the league's, for example if a club doesn't want its teams driving more than 15 miles. It applies whenever that program's teams travel.

1. Under **Program overrides**, choose the program and click **Add override**.
2. Enter its **Travel cap (miles)**. It must be lower than the league's **Travel cap** above; a higher one would push longer trips onto opponents who didn't agree to them. The row warns you if it isn't.
3. Click **Generate draft** (or **Regenerate draft**). The override is saved with the rules.

How the matchmaker uses it:

- **Placing a game:** the away team's program cap applies. When the program with the override is the away team, its own cap applies; when it hosts, the visiting program's cap applies.
- **Pairing:** two teams are paired if at least one of them can travel to the other. So if Northfield has a 15-mile cap and Riverbend is 25 miles away, Riverbend (league cap 30) can still come to Northfield. Every Northfield–Riverbend game is then at Northfield's gyms, and Riverbend never hosts Northfield.
- If neither can travel to the other (both have caps shorter than the distance between them), their teams aren't paired, and the notes say so with both caps.

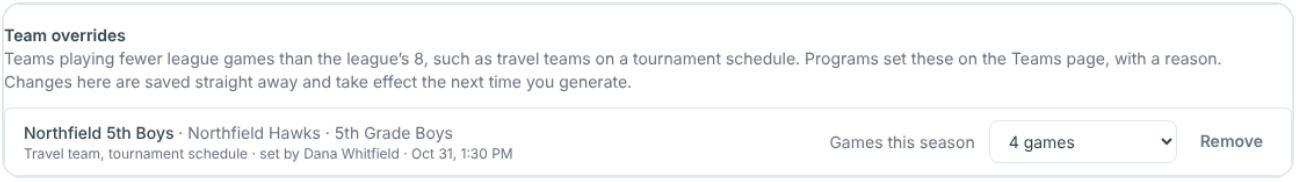
What it costs: the program hosts more of its own games, so home/away balance shifts (it has more home games, its opponents more away games), and its gyms need enough game slots. If its teams end up short, the notes name the override, for example: *"Northfield 5th Boys got 6 of 8 games: Northfield's own 15-mile travel cap means its teams can't travel to Riverbend, so those games have to be at Northfield's gyms. More Northfield game slots, or a higher cap, would help."*

Directors can't set a cap themselves; they send a rule request, and accepting it adds the override here for you. After you generate, a line above the notes shows it (*Built with program override: Northfield Hawks — 15-mile travel cap*). When you move a game by hand, times where a team would travel past its program's cap are flagged with that cap.

Team overrides (games per team)

A program can ask for **fewer league games for one team**, for example a travel team on a tournament schedule. Directors set this themselves on the **Teams** page (**Edit → Games this season**), with a reason; it can only be lower than **Games per team**, and **No league games** leaves the team out. You can do the same from the Teams page.

Under **Team overrides** in the rules panel you see every team override with its program, division, reason and who set it. Change the number with **Games this season**, or click **Remove** to put the team back on the league's count. Unlike the other rules, these are saved straight away (not when you generate), and the program sees the change on its Teams page. Each change is in the Activity log.



Team overrides in the Schedule builder

How the matchmaker uses them:

- Each team aims for its own target. A team with 4 games plays roughly every other round, so its games are spread across the season, and home/away balance is worked out on its own count.
- Its opponents make up the games against other teams in the division, within the rematch limit. If they can't, the notes say why, for example: *"Lakeview 7th Boys got 7 of 8 games: Northfield 7th Boys plays only 4 (team override), so there are fewer games to go around in 7th Grade Boys. Raise "Most games against the same opponent" so other opponents can make up the games, or add a game by hand."*
- Teams with **No league games** get none. If that leaves a division with only one team, the notes say so.

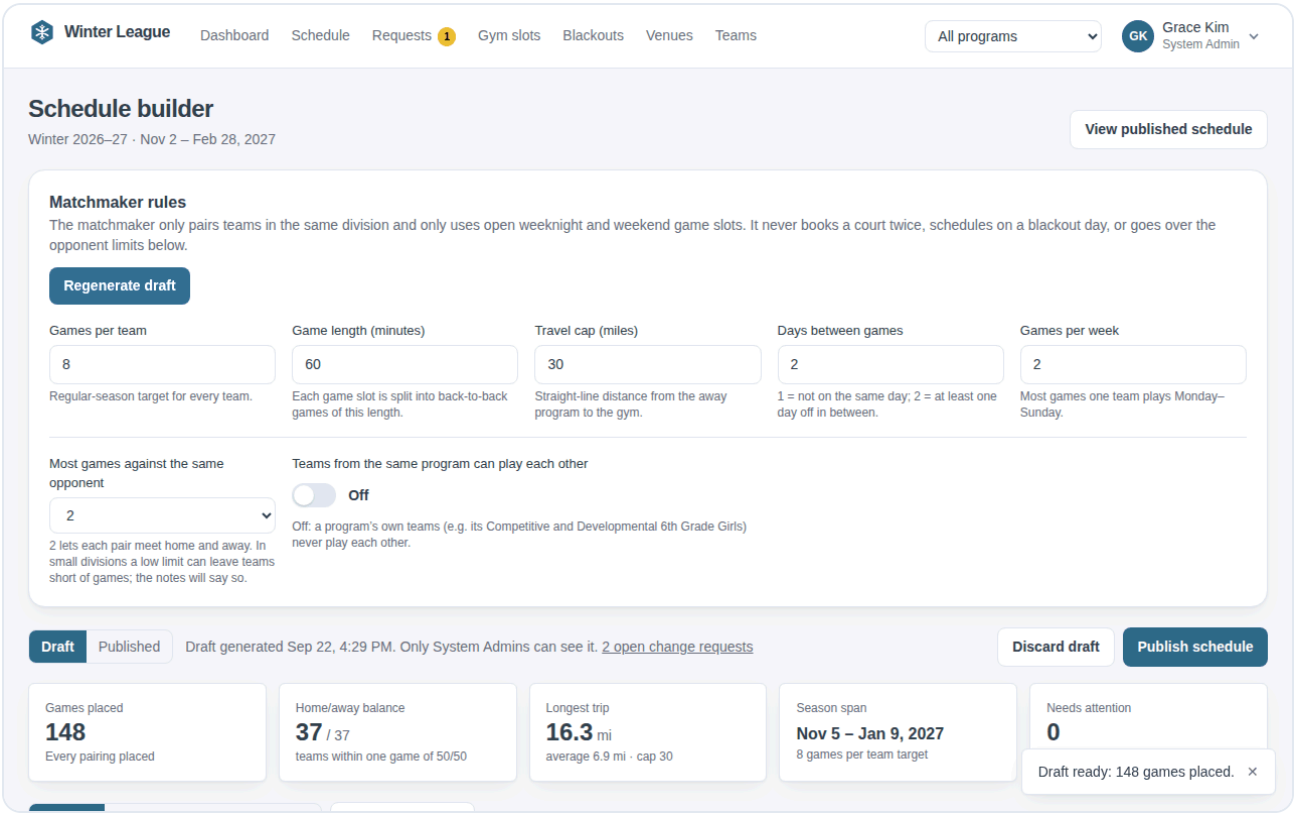
Each draft keeps its own copy of the team overrides. After you generate, a line above the notes shows them (*Built with team override: Northfield 5th Boys — 4 league games*), and the notes list them. If a program changes a target after the draft was built, the rules panel says **Team overrides have changed since this draft**; generate again to use them. The **Team balance** tab shows each team against its own target, for example *4 of 4 (team override)*, and **Add game** warns against the team's own target.

2. Generate a draft

Click **Generate draft** (or **Regenerate draft** to start over). It takes a few seconds. Changed rules are saved when you generate.

Gym slots in blocks. Slots added together over a date range can be edited together: open one under **Gym slots**, change the time, court, type, *Keep for* or notes, and apply it to **this date only**, **this and later dates**, or **every date in the block**. Dates where a published game would no longer fit, or that would clash with another slot, are skipped and listed. Draft games that no longer fit a changed slot go back to **Unplaced**. The steps are in the Program Director guide.

Day preferences. Directors can keep game slots for any mix of divisions (e.g. *4th–6th grade boys and girls on Mondays and Wednesdays*, or *girls on Mondays*) under **Gym slots → Tag game slots**, and you can too for any program. A **Priority** tag means those games take the slot first, before an untagged slot in the same week, and other games use it only if nothing else fits anywhere. An **Only** tag means no other game is ever placed there. The notes report how tagged slots were used, e.g. *"Girls priority slots: 7 of 14 game times used by Girls games; 2 went to other games because nothing else fit"* or *"Girls-only slots: 7 of 14 used; 7 left open (other games can't use them)."* When you move or place a game by hand, a slot kept **only** for other games isn't offered (and is refused), and a **priority** slot for other games is marked so you can avoid it.



A draft schedule

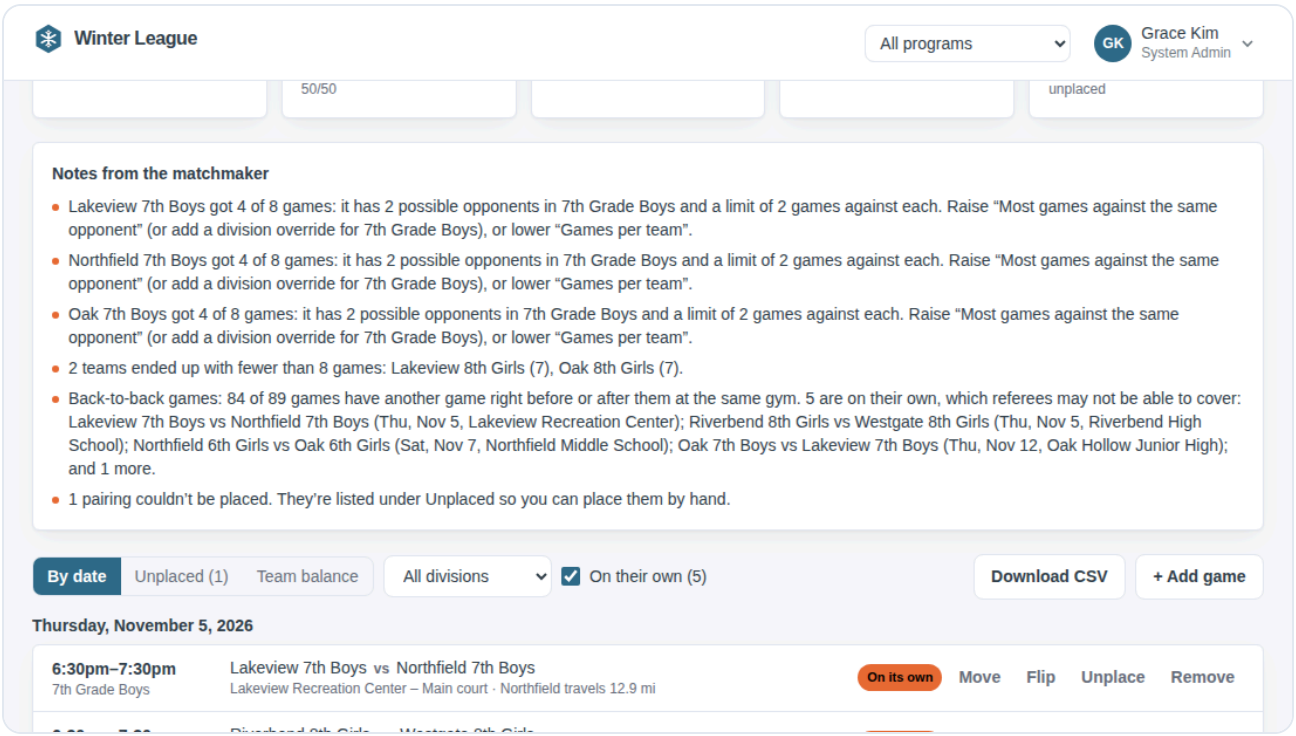
Back-to-back games. Referees work two games in a row at a gym, and a single game at a gym is hard to staff. So the matchmaker stacks games: when it picks a time, one right next to a game already at that gym that day beats an earlier time on another day, and a game that's on its own gets a partner before a gym that already has a pair gets a third. After the draft is built, it also tries to move any game still on its own next to another game at the home program's gyms (the same week first, then up to three weeks either side), or to bring another game in beside it. All of this is best effort: it never breaks a rule (rest days, games per week, travel caps, tagged slots, overrides, blackouts), and it doesn't change who is home or away. The notes report the result, e.g. *"Back-to-back games: 83 of 90 games have another game right before or after them at the same gym. 7 are on their own…"*, naming the single games. If a gym slot only has room for one game that day, the notes say so: ask the director for a longer slot there.

Read the summary cards (games placed, home/away balance, longest trip, season span, anything needing attention) and **Notes from the matchmaker**, which explain in plain words anything it couldn't do, such as a team left short of games and which setting would fix it.

3. Review and adjust

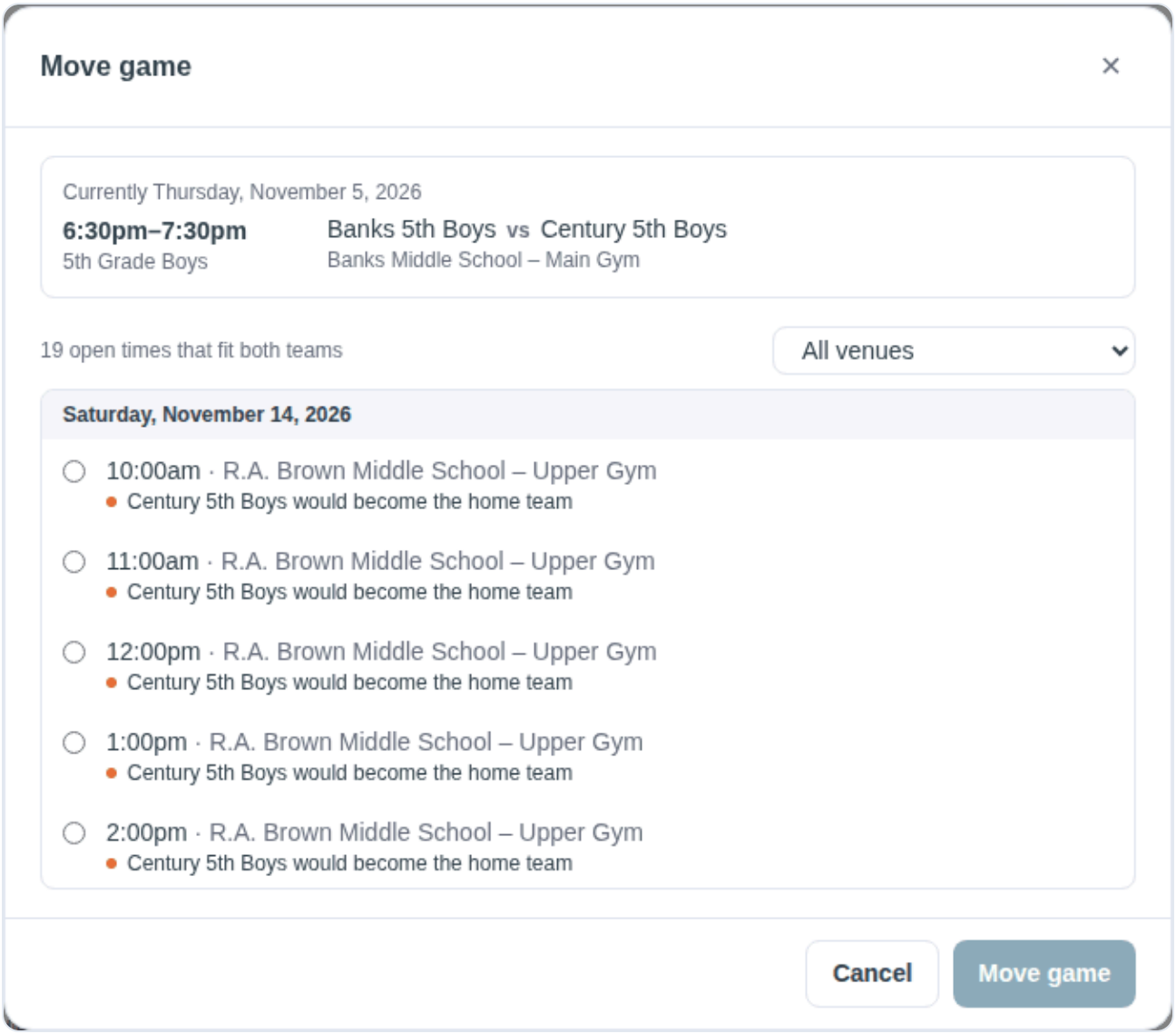
- **By date:** every game. **Move** picks a new time from a list that already passes every rule; **Flip** swaps home and away; **Unplace** takes a game off the calendar but keeps the pairing; **Remove** deletes the pairing from the draft.

- **Unplaced:** pairings the matchmaker couldn't fit. Use **Place game** to put them somewhere by hand, or **Remove** to drop one.
- **Team balance:** each team's games and home/away count. Bold rows are more than one game off 50/50 or short of the target.
- **One program's games:** choose a program in the drop-down at the top of the page (where it says **All programs**) and the three lists show only that program's games, home and away. Combine it with the division filter. The summary cards and the matchmaker's notes stay league-wide; a line above the list says which program you're looking at, with **Show all programs** to go back.
- **On its own:** a game with no other game right before or after it at the same gym that day has an **On its own** badge, because referees may not be able to cover a single game. Tick **On their own (N)** next to the division filter to list only those games, then **Move** each one next to another game (or move another game next to it). The badge follows your edits: it disappears as soon as the game has a neighbor, and appears on a game you leave by itself. These are the games the matchmaker's *Back-to-back games* note counts.

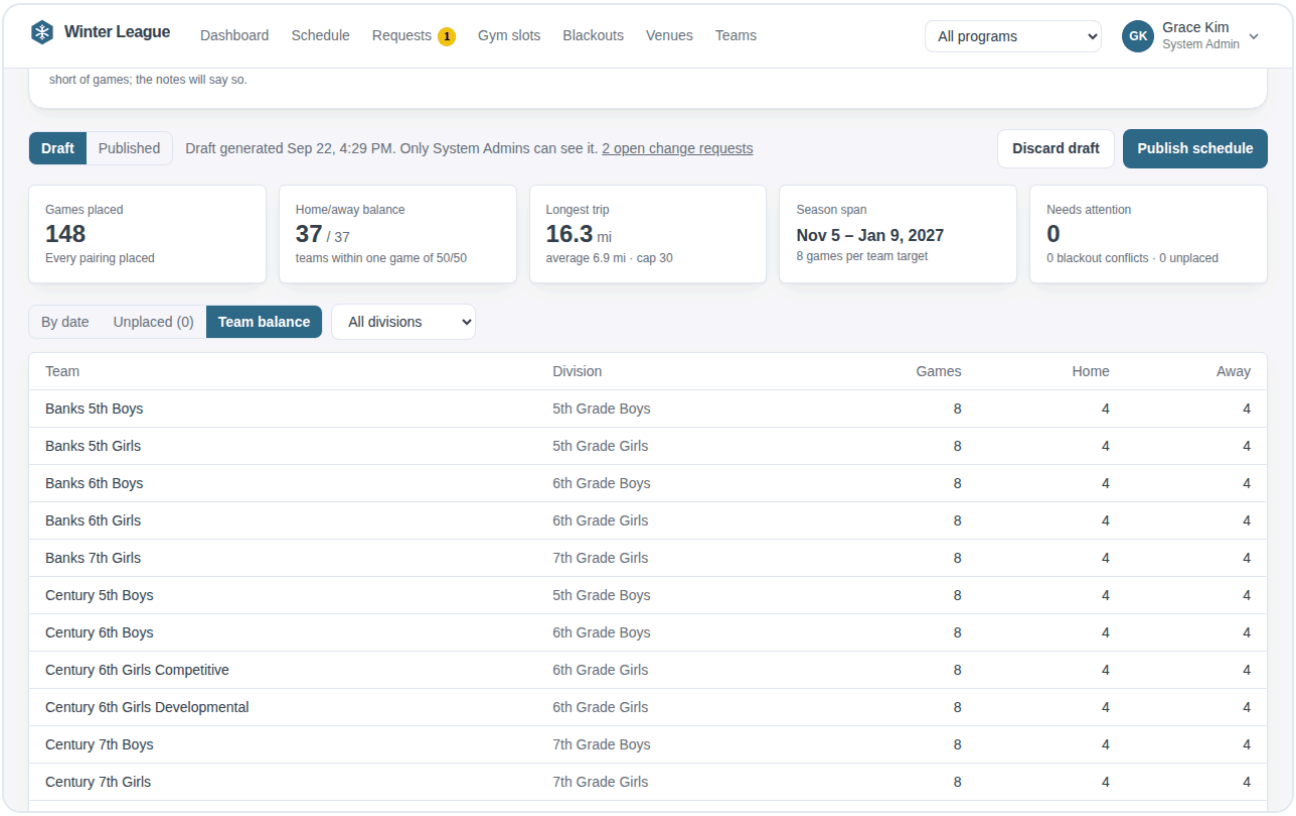


Games on their own, flagged in the draft

- **Download CSV** saves the games you're looking at (the draft, or the published schedule, for all divisions or the one chosen, and for one program if one is chosen) as a spreadsheet file, including unplaced games and each game's travel distance. Games on their own say so in the **Notes** column. The **Schedule** page has the same button for the published schedule, with its filters.



Moving a game

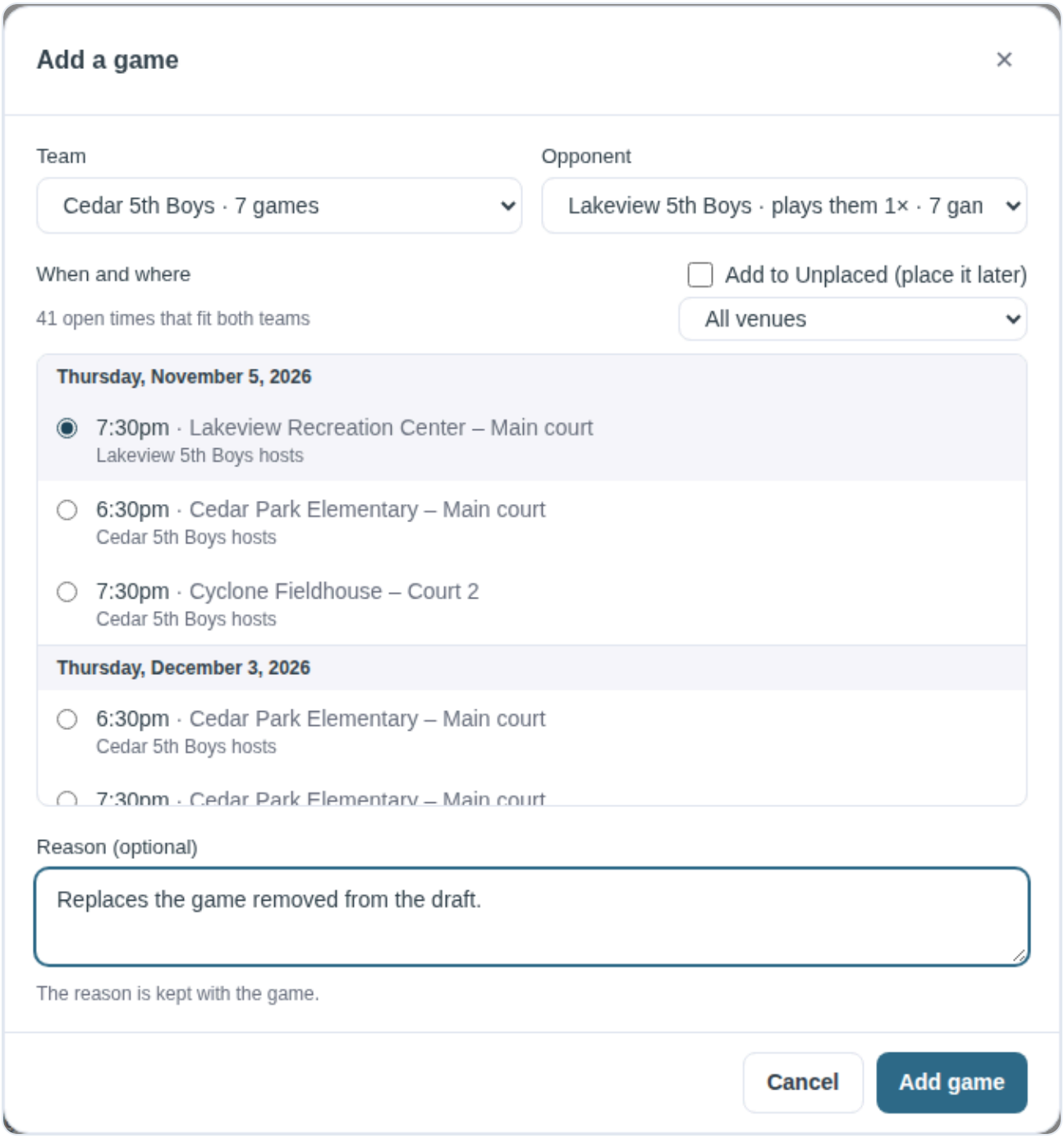


Team balance

Removing and adding games

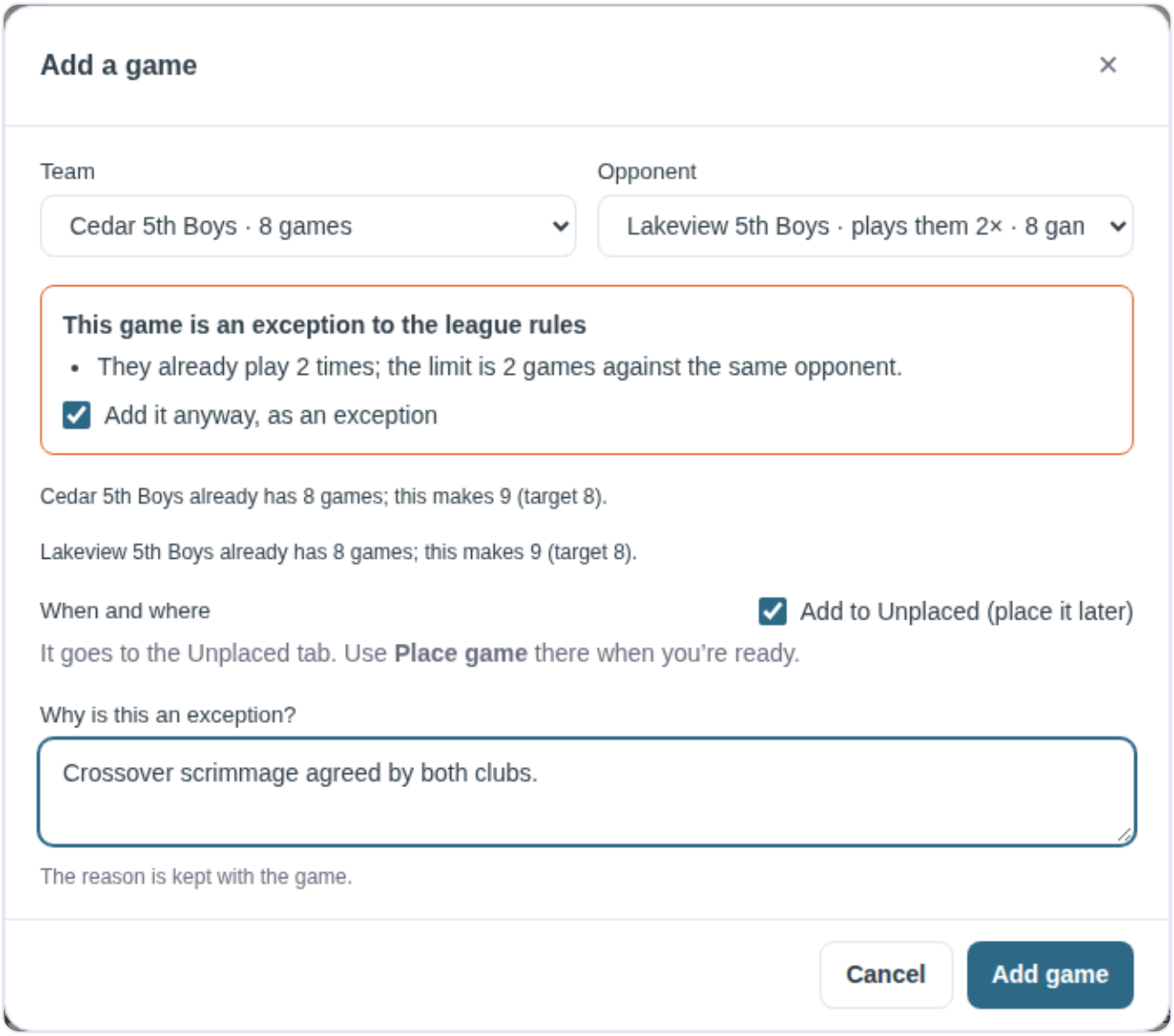
Not every pairing has to come from the matchmaker.

- **Remove** (drafts only) deletes a game from the draft after you confirm. Each team then has one game fewer, which shows on the **Team balance** tab. On the published schedule, games are **cancelled** instead, so there's a record of them.
- **+ Add game** (next to the division filter) creates a game by hand, in the draft or on the published schedule:
    1. Choose the **Team**, then the **Opponent**. Each opponent shows how often the two teams already play and how many games it has. Opponents within the league rules are listed first.
    2. Pick a time. Like **Move**, the list only offers open game slots at either team's gyms that pass every rule (court free, no blackout, days between games, games per week). The court decides who hosts. In a draft you can instead tick **Add to Unplaced** and place it later.
    3. Add a reason if you like (it's kept with the game) and click **Add game**.



Adding a game

Exceptions. Opponents that break a league rule (a team in another division, a team from the same program, or a pair that already meets as often as **Most games against the same opponent** allows) are listed under **Exceptions to the league rules**. Choosing one shows which rule it breaks. To add it anyway, tick **Add it anyway, as an exception** and say why. The rule and your reason are kept with the game, which shows an **Exception** badge (hover over it for the details). Games added by hand show an **Added** badge.



Adding a game as an exception

If either team would go over **Games per team**, the dialog says so. That's a note, not a block.

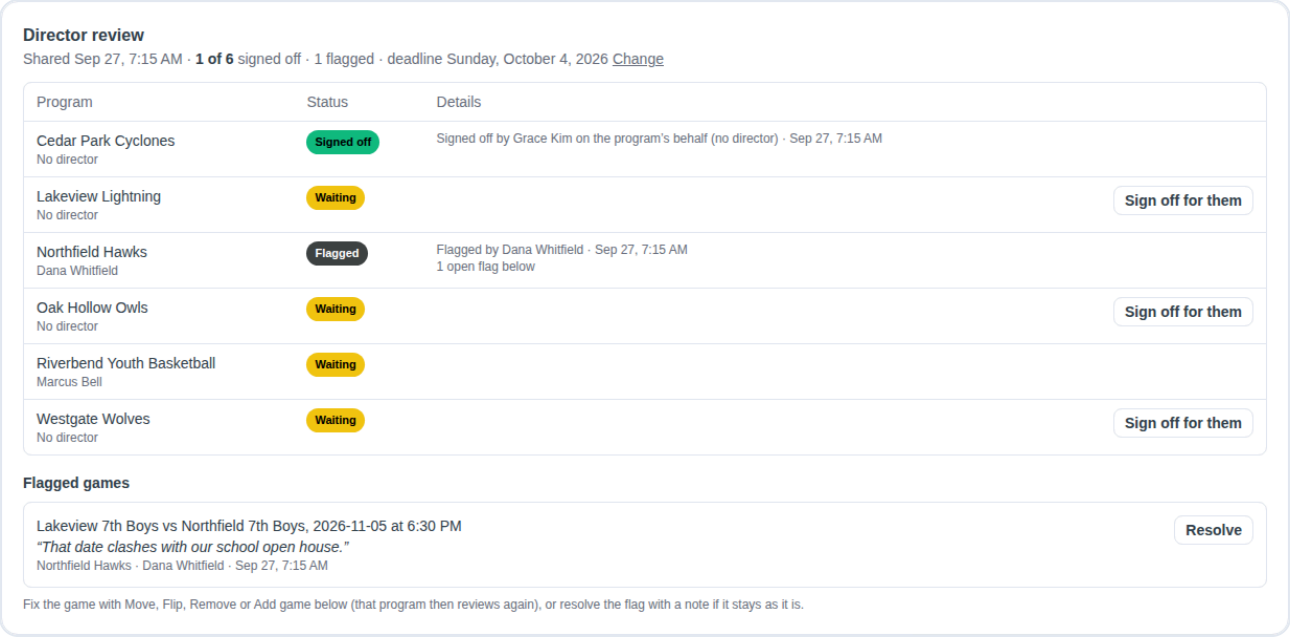
> **Regenerating a draft** starts over from the rules, so games you added or removed in the draft are lost. Make those edits last.

4. Share with directors and collect sign-offs

Before a draft can be published, every program with teams in it has to sign off. The **Director review** panel sits between the rules and the draft.

1. Pick a **Sign-off deadline** (a week from today to start with) and click **Share with directors**. Each Program Director is emailed. They see **only their own program's games**, read-only, under **Draft review**. Coaches, referees, and the assignor still see nothing until you publish.

2. The panel shows each program's status: **Waiting**, **Signed off**, or **Flagged**, with who decided and when.
3. **Flags.** A director who has a problem with a game flags it with a note (e.g. *"11/5 clashes with our school event"*). You're emailed, and the flag appears under **Flagged games**. Either fix the game (**Move**, **Flip**, **Remove**, **Add game**), or click **Resolve** and add a note explaining why it stays. The director is emailed either way and signs off when their games work. Signing off withdraws that program's open flags.
4. **Flagging for a program.** If a director tells you about a problem by phone or email, click **Flag a game** on that program's row, choose the game and say what's wrong. It's recorded as on behalf of that program, and its director is emailed. Signing off stays with the director.
5. **Programs without a director.** Click **Sign off for them**. It's recorded as signed off by you *on the program's behalf*, so the record shows nobody from the program reviewed it. Programs with a director always sign off themselves.
6. **Changes after sign-off.** When you change a game in a shared draft, only the programs in that game go back to **Waiting**. Their directors are emailed with what changed, and the panel shows *"Needs to review again: …"*. Every other program keeps its sign-off.



Director review

Change next to the deadline moves it (it can't be in the past). **Regenerate draft** starts a brand-new draft that has to be shared and signed off again.

5. Publish

Publish schedule unlocks when every program has signed off. Until then it's greyed out, with a line saying how many programs are still to sign off. Coaches, directors, and referees see the

schedule as soon as it's published. **Discard draft** throws a draft away without affecting anything published.

Publishing without every sign-off. Once the deadline has passed (the day after the deadline date, Pacific time), the button becomes **Publish anyway…**. It lists the programs that haven't signed off and asks why you're publishing now. The override is recorded on the schedule (who, when, which programs, and your note), in **Activity**, and in the Schedule builder's **Published** view. Before the deadline there's no override. Move the deadline if you need to.

> **Publishing again later** replaces the current schedule. The app warns you first: open change requests on the old schedule are cancelled, and referee assignments carry over only to games that didn't change.

Changes after publishing

In the Schedule builder, switch to **Published** to move, flip, **Cancel**, or **Restore** a live game, or use **+ Add game** to add one. An added game goes live straight away: both teams' directors and coaches are emailed, both programs see it in Activity, and it gets referee slots for the assignor to fill. Cancelling asks for a reason, which shows on everyone's schedule next to the game; **Restore** puts it back and clears the reason. Coaches and directors can also ask for a cancellation through a change request, which comes to you for sign-off like any other. Every change is logged and both teams' directors see it. Referees on a moved game stay on it if they're still free; otherwise they're removed and emailed. Cancelling a game releases its referees.

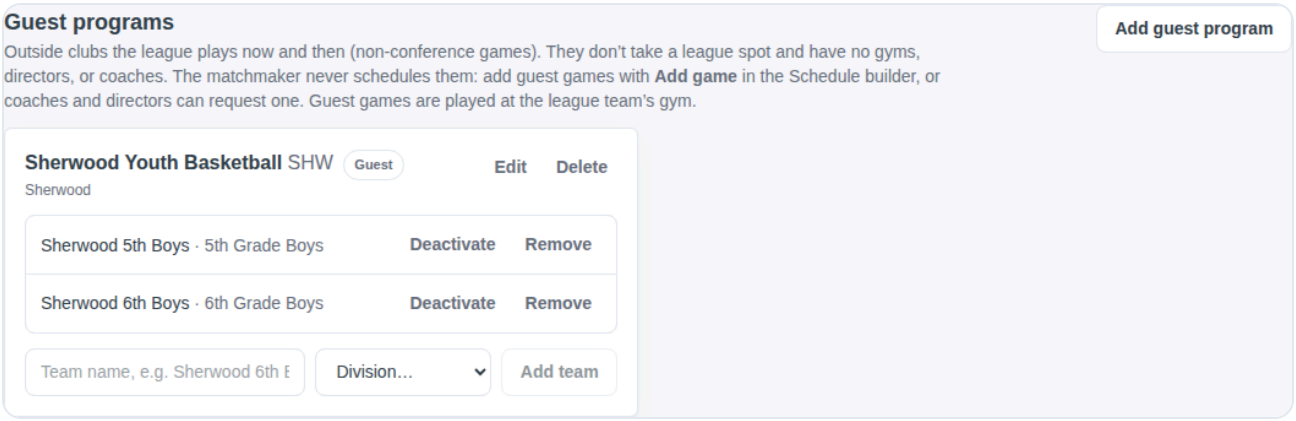
Guest (non-conference) teams

A guest team is a team from outside the league, such as *Sherwood 6th Boys*, that a league team plays now and then. Guest games are played at the league team's gym and otherwise work like any other game: court checks, referees, check-in, scores, payouts, and Activity.

Setting up a guest program

Menu → League admin → Programs, then **Guest programs** below the league's programs.

1. Click **Add guest program** and enter its name, short code, and city. A guest program doesn't take one of the league's program spots.
2. On its card, add a team for each division it plays in: type the team name, choose the division, and click **Add team**. The teams can be reused all season.

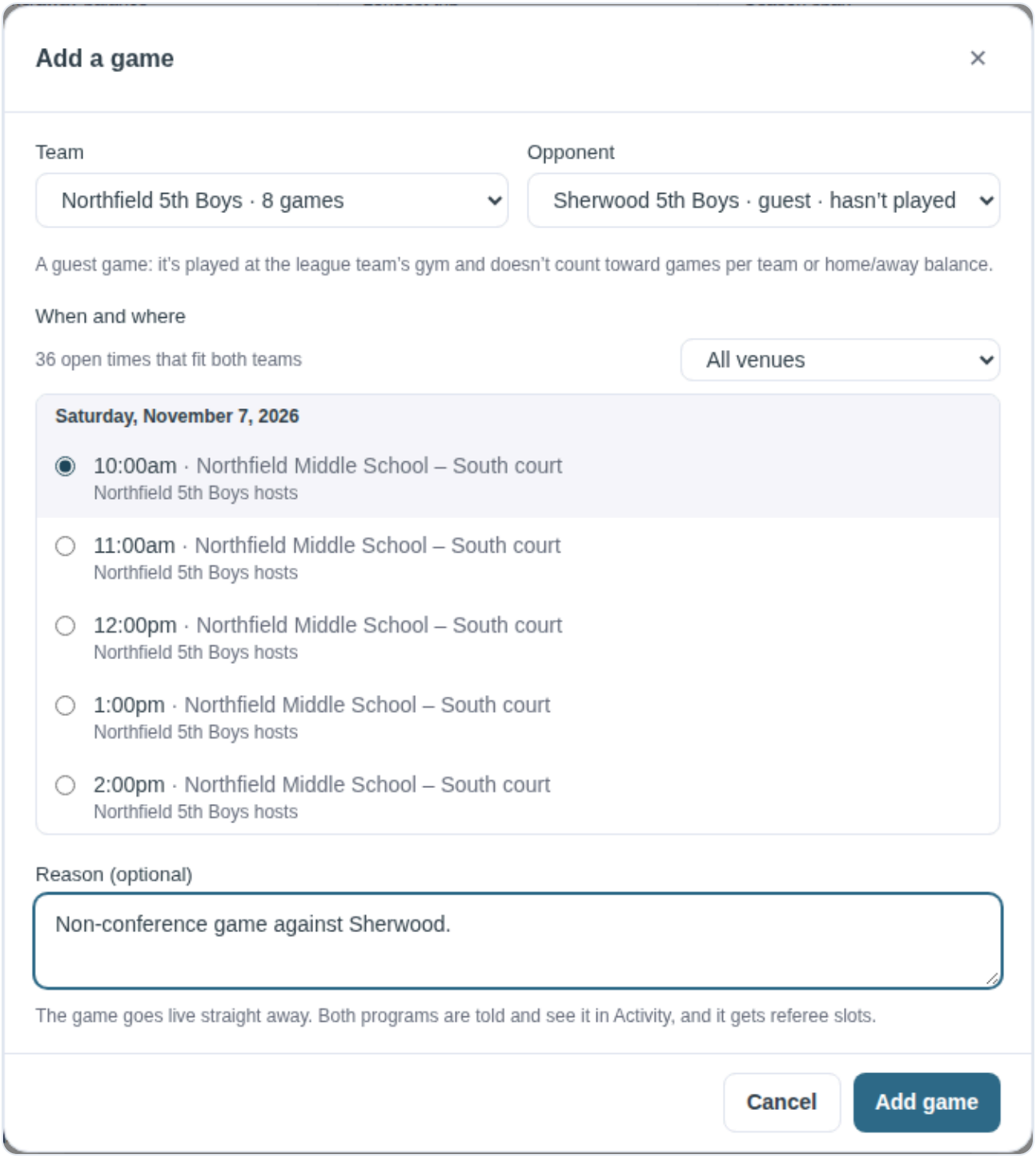


Guest programs

Guest programs are kept out of the rest of the app on purpose. They have no venues, gym slots, blackouts, directors, or coaches, and they don't appear in program pickers or the setup checklist. **Deactivate** a guest team (or make the whole program inactive) to stop it being offered for new games. A team with games can't be removed, only deactivated.

Adding a guest game

The matchmaker never schedules guests. Add guest games by hand with **+ Add game** in the Schedule builder, choosing the league team first and then the guest team (marked *guest* in the opponent list). You can also choose a guest team first, under **Guest teams** in the team list.

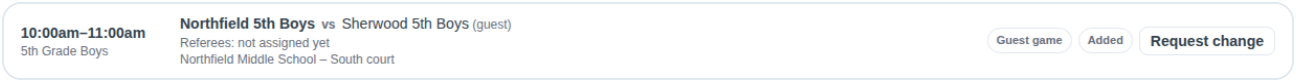


Adding a guest game

- **Where:** only open game slots at the league team's gyms are offered, so the league team always hosts. Two guest teams can't play each other.
- **Rules:** the usual opponent rules apply. A guest team in another division, or over the rematch limit, is an exception that needs a reason.
- **Counting:** guest games don't count toward **Games per team** or home/away balance. The **Team balance** tab shows them in a separate **Guest games** column, and adding one never

triggers the "over the target" note.

- **Marked everywhere:** guest teams show *(guest)* after their name and the game has a **Guest game** badge, on every schedule, the assignor's board, and the payout export. The guest program pays one of the referees (Referee 2), like any away program; its total is under **Referee payouts → What each program owes**.



A guest game on the schedule

Coaches and directors can also ask for a guest game with **Request a game**. There's no guest director to agree, so their request comes straight to you after their own director's endorsement. The same goes for moving or cancelling a guest game.

Final scores

Coaches and directors of the two teams enter final scores after each game, and you can enter or correct any game's score the same way: **Schedule → Enter score** or **Edit score**. When you enter or correct one, both teams' coaches and directors are emailed. See the Coach guide for the steps.

- Every entry, correction, and clearing is in **Activity**, with who made it and the previous score, so disagreements can be settled from the record.
- A game with a final score can't be moved, unplaced, or cancelled until its score is cleared. **Flip** swaps the scores along with home and away.
- Republishing the schedule keeps scores on games that didn't change.

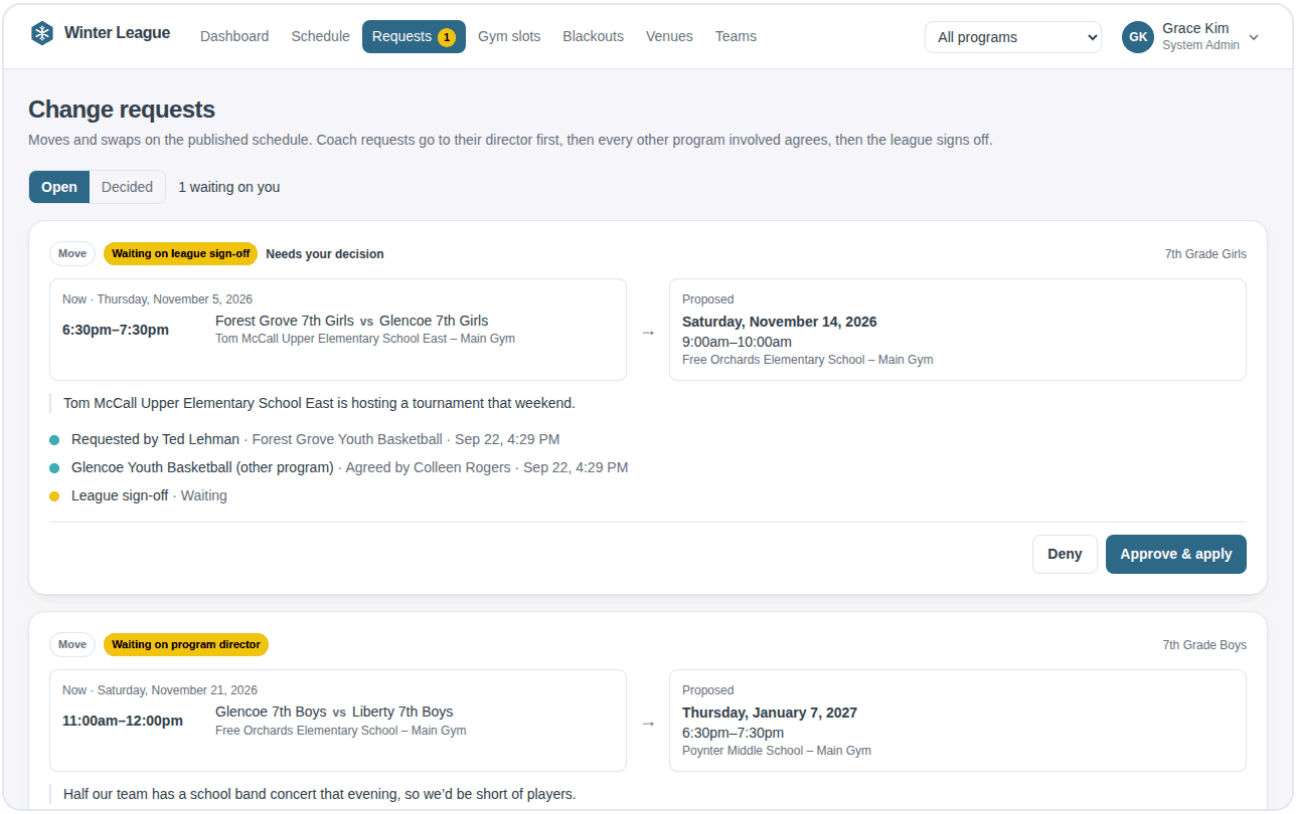
Change requests: league sign-off

Coaches and directors ask for changes from the Schedule page: moving, swapping, or cancelling a game, or adding an extra one (**Request a game**). A request goes to the requesting coach's own director, then to every other program involved, and finally to you.

Menu → League → Requests. Requests waiting on you say **Needs your decision**.

- **Approve & apply** checks the change against the schedule as it is right now, then applies it. If something has taken that time in the meantime, it tells you, and you can deny with a note so the requester can pick another time.
- **Deny** needs a short note for the requester. You can deny at any stage.

- A request to **add a game** (marked **Add game**) creates the game when you approve it, after checking again that the time is still free and the two teams are still within the league rules. Requests can't be exceptions. If a team needs a game outside the rules, add it yourself with **+ Add game**. A request involving a guest team skips the "other program" step, since guests have no director.

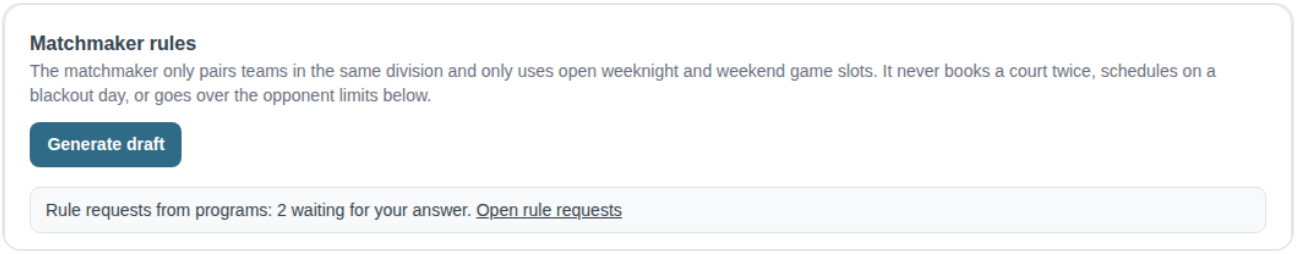


A request waiting for league sign-off

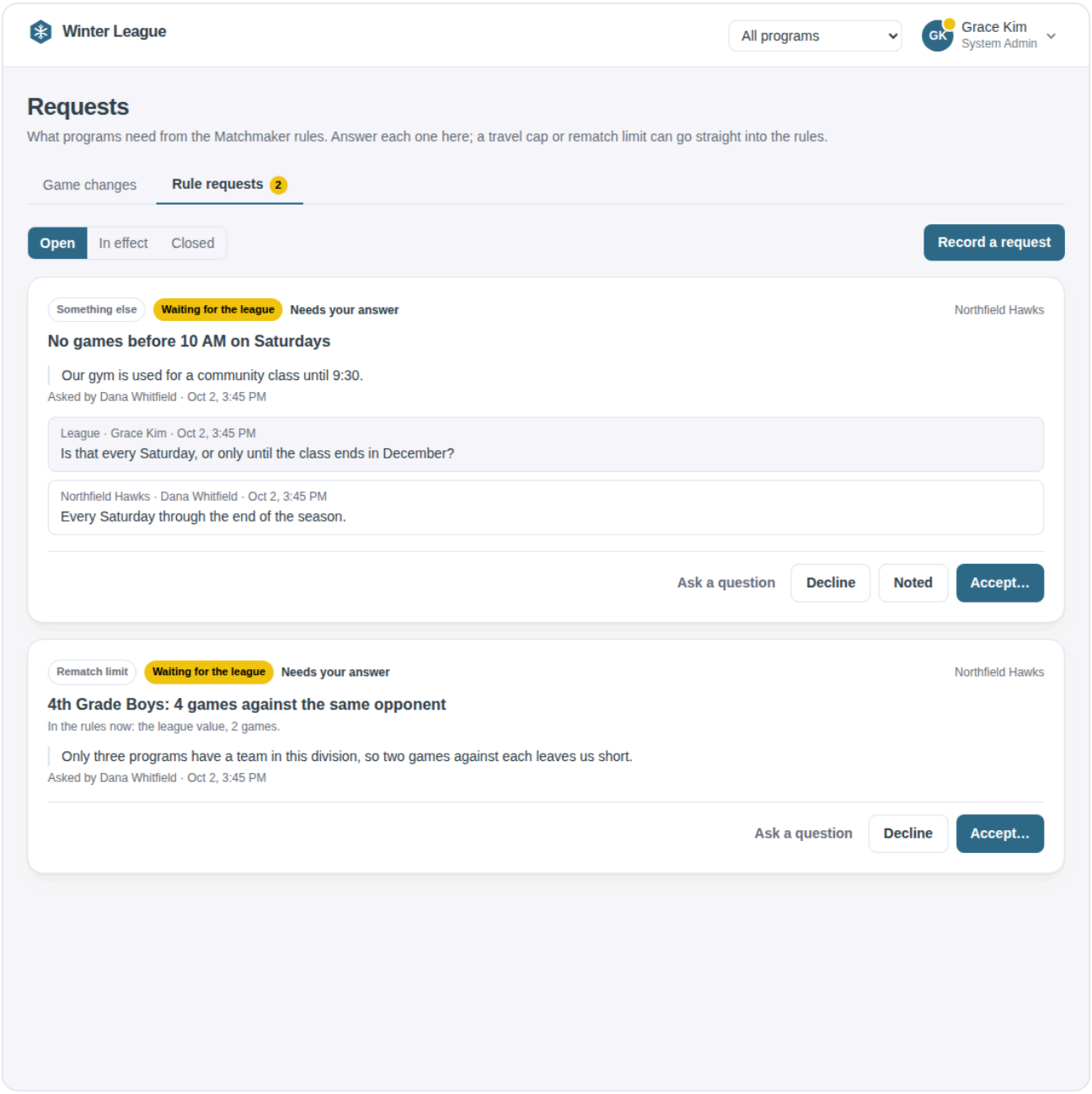
Rule requests from programs

Program Directors use rule requests to tell you what their program needs from the Matchmaker rules: a lower travel cap, a different rematch limit for a division, a change to a league rule, or anything else the schedule should take into account. Each one comes with a reason, and your answer is kept with it. Only you and the program that sent it can see a request.

Menu → League → Requests, then the **Rule requests** tab. The tab and the Requests menu item show how many are waiting for your answer, and the Schedule builder shows the same count above the rules, so you see them before generating a draft.



The rule request count in the Schedule builder

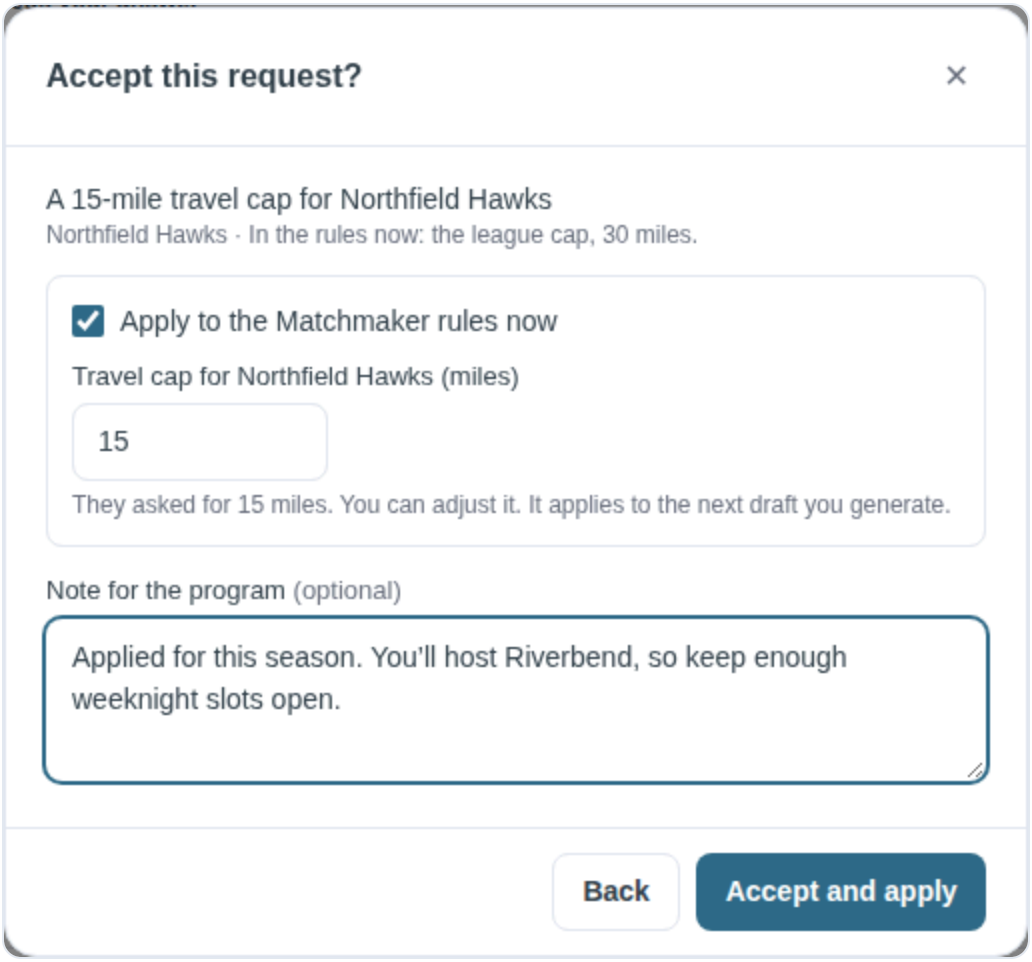


Rule requests waiting for an answer

Answering a request

- **Ask a question:** when you need more before deciding. The program is emailed, and the request waits under **Question for the program** until they reply.
- **Accept…:** you agree.
  - For a **travel cap** or **rematch limit**, **Apply to the Matchmaker rules now** is ticked. The value they asked for is filled in and you can change it, for example 20 miles instead of 15. Choosing **Accept and apply** adds the program override or division override for you. It applies to the next draft you generate, not to a draft or published schedule already built. Untick the box to set it yourself later in the Schedule builder.
  - For a **league rule** or **something else**, accepting records that you agree. Change the rule yourself in the Schedule builder if one needs changing.
- **Noted:** for a request the matchmaker can't do by itself (for example *No games before 10 AM on Saturdays*). It's kept on record for you to check when reviewing a draft.
- **Decline:** needs a note saying why.

A note for the program is optional when accepting or noting. The program's directors are emailed with your decision and note each time.



Accepting a travel cap and applying it

Requests in effect

Accepted and noted requests move to **In effect** and stay there until the program withdraws them or you end them. Read this list when you review a draft: it's the record of what each program was promised.

- **Each new season:** every request in effect is marked **Confirm for this season**. Choose **Still applies this season** to keep it, or **End…** with a note if it no longer applies.
- **End…** closes a request and tells the program why. It doesn't change the rules: if the request was applied, remove the override under **Schedule builder → Division overrides** or **Program overrides**.
- **When a program withdraws** a request that was applied, you're emailed and the override stays in the rules until you remove it the same way.

Recording a request for a program

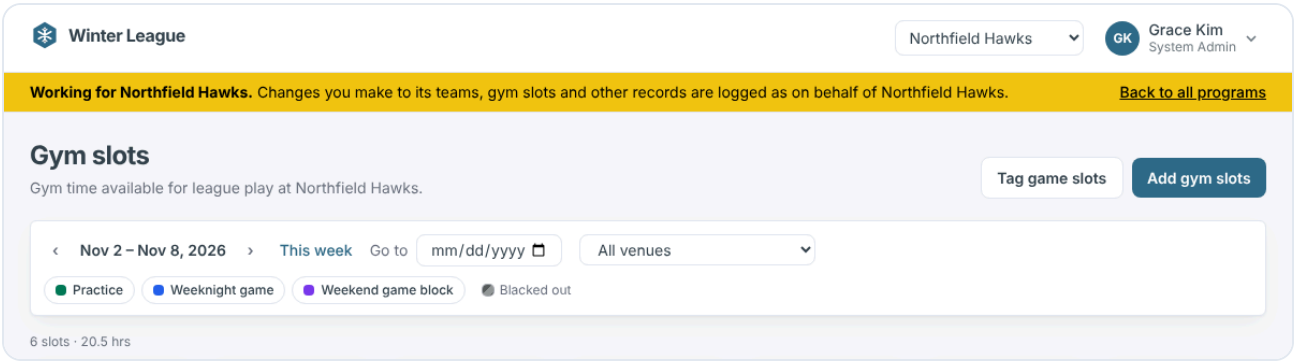
If a director tells you by phone, text, or email, choose **Record a request**, pick the program, and fill it in as they would. It's then on record with the rest, and you answer it the same way.

Every request, question, reply, and decision is in the **Activity** log under **Requests**. A value applied to the rules also appears under **Schedule**.

Helping a program

Directors can ask you to set things up for them: venues, teams, gym slots, blackouts, directory contacts, or a team's games override. You can do anything their director can on those pages.

1. Choose the program in the header (or, on a program page with **All programs** picked, under **Helping a program with its ...?**).
2. A yellow bar reads **Working for Northfield Hawks** on every page, and each page shows only that program's records. Work as the director would.
3. Click **Back to all programs** when you're done.



Working for a program

Every change you make to a program's records is logged with **— on behalf of** the program, for example *Added 12 weeknight game slots at Hawks Community Center – Main court ... — on behalf of Northfield Hawks*. The program's director sees these in their Activity log and on their dashboard (**The league made 3 changes for your program this week**). In **Activity**, tick **Only changes made on behalf of a program** to list them.

Two things stay with the director: **signing off** a draft (you can flag a game for them, and publish anyway after the deadline), and **approving change requests** as their program (you give the league's final approval, and can move a game directly).

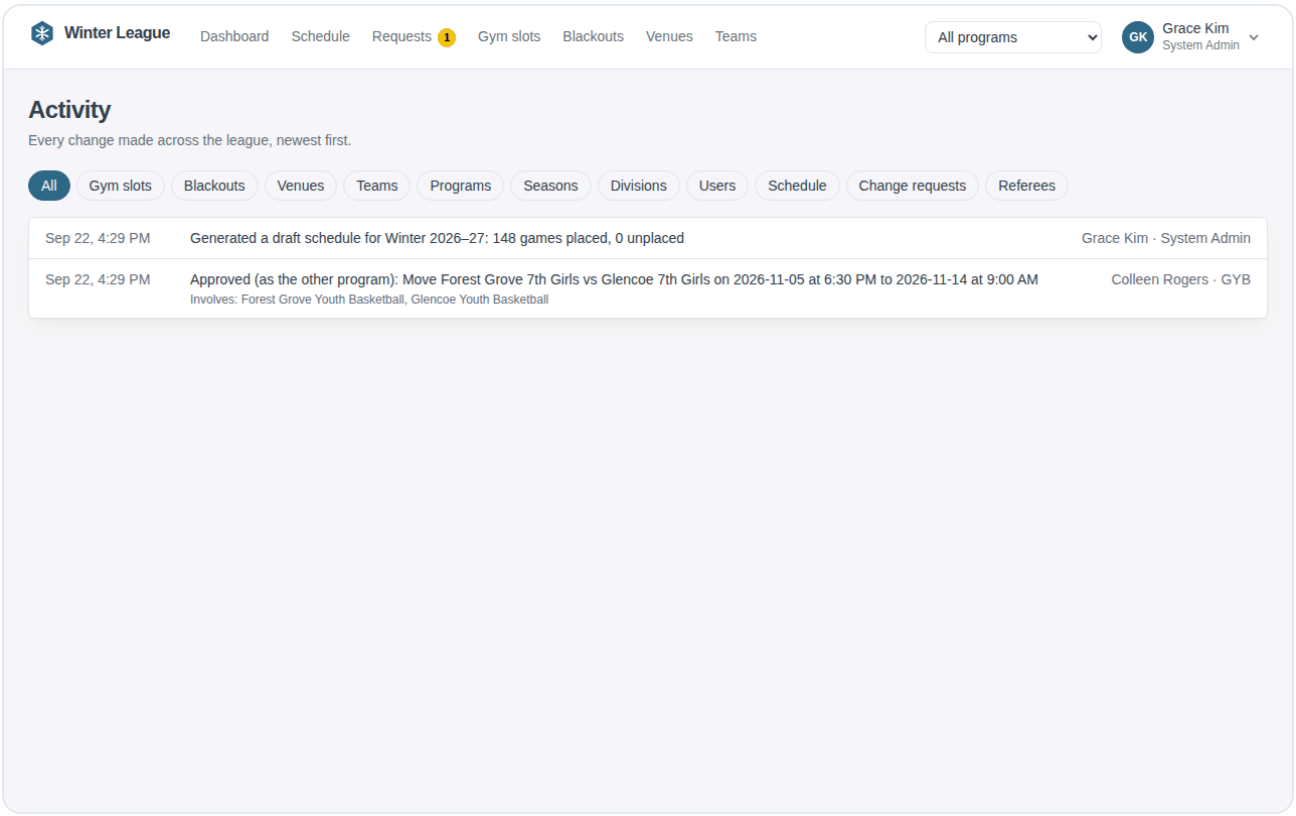
Preseason

Menu → Scheduling → Preseason shows how many teams are open and every request and arranged scrimmage or joint practice across the league. Directors arrange them without league sign-off; you can **Cancel...** any of them (both programs are emailed). Choose a program in the

header to open its teams, arrange a scrimmage on its behalf, or **Accept** or **Decline** a request waiting for that program's answer (its director is emailed). Preseason games are kept apart from league games: they don't count toward standings, games per team, or home/away balance, and they aren't on the referee board or in payouts. Every step is in **Activity** under **Preseason**.

Activity

Menu → League admin → Activity lists every change across the league, newest first: who did it (with their program or role) and which programs it involves. Filter by type with the buttons at the top, or tick **Only changes made on behalf of a program** to see what you and other admins did for programs.



Activity

Referees and everything else

Programs pay the referees, one each per game: the home program pays Referee 1, the away program pays Referee 2, and a lone referee is split half each (a game between two of a program's own teams is paid by that one program). Guest programs pay their referee like any other program: they're the away side, so Referee 2. A guest has no director or login, so its total

appears only in your and the assignor's report, marked *(guest)*, and the league collects it from the club. Program Directors see and export only the referees their own program pays; you and the Referee Assignor see the whole league under **Referee payouts**, with **What each program owes** and a **Paid by** on every game. The rule applies to every game, including ones already played. Programs pay referees directly (referees add their **Venmo username** on My games, and a director's **Pay...** button opens Venmo with the amount filled in), then **Mark as paid**; the referee confirms with **Got it**. Choose a program in the header to see its payouts and mark payments on its behalf (e.g. for a guest program). The Referee Assignor guide has the details. A program can instead **prepay the Referee Assignor** into a **reserve** (Menu → Referees → Referee reserves): the assignor pays its referees and each payment comes out of it, with deposits, a running statement, low-balance emails, and a refund of what's left at season end. Guest programs can have one too. See Referee reserves. As a System Admin you can also do everything a Program Director and the Referee Assignor can. For step-by-step instructions, see the Program Director guide (gym slots, blackouts, venues, teams), the Referee Assignor guide (assignments and payouts), the Coach guide, and the Referee guide.